

TOD LEASEHOLD PLOTS TO
GET FREEHOLD STATUS **P3**



CONG ACCUSES GOVT OF TAKING NO
STEPS TO CONTROL INFLATION **P5**

'IT'S A NATIONAL-LEVEL
EXPERIMENT' **P12**



BJP reboots its youth outreach

YUVA SAMVAD: PM Modi meets BJP's new 65-member national team

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, August 22

Prime Minister Narendra Modi met the BJP's newly appointed national office-bearers at the party headquarters in the Capital on Saturday. It was his first meeting with the new 65-member national team of the party, unveiled on August 17, under president Nitin Nabin.

"Organisational meetings are all about new ideas and perspectives aimed at strengthening the party and deepening its connect with the people. Great interaction with fellow party colleagues and the new organisational team," PM Modi wrote on X after the meeting. Among the prominent appointments in the wider reshuffle were former Union minister Smriti Irani and RSS national executive member Ram Madhav, who returned to key organisational roles.

Earlier in the day, BJP chief Nabin chaired a meeting of the office-bearers to discuss the party's organisational strategy, upcoming Assembly elections, grassroots mobilisation, and communication



NEW TEAM, NEW TASK

» After the mess up in mishandling the students' protest at Jantar Mantar last month, the BJP is gearing up to engage with the youth through various programmes

» Nabin asked the newly appointed office-bearers to prioritise 'Yuva Samvad', or continuous engagement with young people

» The BJP plans to launch major youth outreach initiatives in near future

» 'Discussions focused on devising an effective campaign to reach youth aged 14 and above, who comprise the Gen Z and Gen Alpha generations'

» THE BJP ALSO PASSED A RESOLUTION CONDEMNING THE CONGRESS WORKING COMMITTEE'S DECISION TO SING ONLY THE FIRST TWO STANZAS OF VANDE MATARAM AT PARTY EVENTS

of government initiatives.

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CONTINUED ON P4

TIES, TRADE ON AGENDA Jaishankar heads to Russia for key talks

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 22

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar will undertake a two-day visit to Moscow beginning Sunday to hold talks with his Russian interlocutors on a range of issues, including bilateral trade and investment ties.

Along with Russian First Deputy Prime Minister Denis Manturov, Jaishankar will co-chair a meeting of the India-Russia Inter-Governmental Commission on Trade, Economic, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation (IRIGC-TEC)

The external affairs minister will also meet Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov and exchange perspectives on regional and global issues, according to an official statement.

Meanwhile, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Saturday said that



DIPLOMACY

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India and China have an interest in maintaining a "stable" bilateral relationship, while asserting that the state of the border would naturally determine the state of the ties.

CONTINUED ON P4

FARE ROW: Driver kills passenger with bricks

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 22

A refusal to pay a fare of around Rs 1,000 triggered a quarrel inside a van that turned fatal when a driver beat the passenger with bricks and an earthen-pot-like object before dumping the body on the roadside in the Naraina area here, police said on Saturday.

During questioning, accused Rajinder Kumar alias Annu, 59, told police that he picked up the deceased from IFFCO Chowk in Gurugram, Haryana, in the van on August 17, an officer said. According to police, the dispute broke out during the journey over payment of the fare, allegedly around Rs 1,000.

The passenger allegedly refused to pay, leading to a quarrel inside the vehicle in West Delhi, police said.

CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

IIT-D student jumps to death

NEW DELHI: A 31-year-old MSc Physics student at IIT Delhi died after allegedly jumping from the sixth floor of a campus building on Saturday morning here, police said. The officer said no suicide note was recovered from the scene, adding that a mobile phone found in the deceased's pocket would be examined. **SEE P3**

Maha: FIR against Dipke

LATUR (MAHARASHTRA): Police in the district have registered a case against Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) convenor Abhijeet Dipke and others for allegedly entering a government school without permission, disrupting official work and threatening teachers. The First Information Report (FIR) was registered at AUSA police station on a complaint filed by Sayyed Shamshad-bano Khairatali (53), a teacher at a Zilla Parishad Urdu school. **MPOST**

Power cut, 49 face retest

JAIPUR: Forty-nine of the 192 candidates appearing in the All India Ayush Post Graduate Entrance Test (AIAPGET) at the Satya Sai PG College could not complete the computer-based exam due to power outage with some of them alleging that there was copying during the disruption in the presence of the observer. The exam at Satya Sai PG College was disrupted by a 20-minute power outage. The two-hour test began at 10 am. **MPOST**

TRADE TENSIONS FLARE

Tariff war: US slaps, Canada strikes back

ASSOCIATED PRESS
WASHINGTON, August 22

The United States imposed 50 per cent tariffs on \$20 billion worth of Canadian products early Saturday, and Canada immediately said it would retaliate after last-ditch negotiations failed to resolve the latest strain in relations between the historic allies.

President Donald Trump's import taxes will hit about 5 per cent of what Canada ships to the United States every year, including products ranging from hockey sticks to tongue depressors.

"Canada will match those tariffs dollar for dollar to protect our workers and businesses," Prime Minister Mark Carney said in a statement. The retaliation escalates the trade conflict and calls into question the future of a North American trade agreement covering the United States,

RETALIATION

» Canada will impose retaliatory tariffs on US goods beginning September 8

» The move escalates a trade conflict after Washington imposed 50 per cent tariffs on about \$20 billion worth of Canadian products and last-ditch negotiations collapsed late Friday in Washington

Canada and Mexico that is crucial to industry in all three countries.

Canada will impose retaliatory tariffs on US goods beginning September 8, Carney said on Saturday.

The move escalates a trade conflict after Washington imposed 50 per cent tariffs on about \$20 billion worth of Canadian products and last-ditch negotiations collapsed late Friday in Washington.

Carney said the dollar-for-dollar retaliation would target steel, **CONTINUED ON P4**

ON THE MOVE



A man transports goods on camel-drawn carts along the Rajkot-Kutch highway in Rajkot, Gujarat, on Saturday

PTI

Delhi govt issues H1N1 advisory

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 22

The Delhi government has issued a health advisory urging people to follow respiratory hygiene, avoid crowded places and seek timely medical advice as

cases of H1N1 (swine flu) rise in the national capital.

Delhi has recorded over 2,300 Influenza-A cases this year, including over 1,777 H1N1 cases till Friday. The health department said 114 H1N1 cases were reported on Thursday alone.

The advisory asks people to cover their mouth and nose while coughing or sneezing, wash their hands regularly with soap and water, wear masks in crowded places and avoid close contact with people suffering from respiratory illnesses. **CONTINUED ON P4**

FROM SEPT 1, E-PASSES ON PHONES FOR IMMIGRATION CLEARANCE

For flyers abroad, boarding passes go digital

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

Passengers flying out of Indian airports will no longer be required to carry a physical boarding pass as immigration authorities have decided to do away with the stamping of this document from September 1, officials said on Saturday.

Instead, passengers travelling abroad will have to produce an e-boarding pass on their smartphones for immigration clearance, the officials said.

The Bureau of Immigration (BOI) under the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has recently communicated the official directive to airport authorities after the agency found that the physical stamping of boarding passes for immigration purposes was causing "inconvenience" to passengers. Instances of errors in reading



TRAVEL GETS PAPERLESS

» Instances of errors in reading boarding passes due to 'improper or incorrect' stamping were also being reported and, hence, it was decided to do away with this procedure: Official

» 'The matter has been examined by the BOI and it has now been decided to do away with the mandatory requirement of physical boarding passes and the stamping of boarding passes'

» They, however, said physical boarding passes will continue to be accepted but will not be stamped by the immigration authorities from September 1

boarding passes due to "improper or incorrect" stamping were also being reported and, hence, it was decided to do away with this procedure, the officials said.

"The matter has been examined by the BOI and it has now been decided to do away with the mandatory requirement of physical boarding passes and the stamping of boarding passes at immigration counters at all international airports in the country," the officials said quoting the directive.

They, however, said physical boarding passes will continue to be accepted but will not be stamped by the immigration authorities from September 1.

Security officials added that boarding passes of international travellers were also not being stamped by the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) during individual frisking and they were supposed to be only produced for clearance by immigration authorities.

The boarding pass stamping by CISF for both domestic and international passengers was stopped many years ago, they added.

The officials said a pilot project to do away with the stamping of the immigration entry and exit for Indian passport holders is also planned to be done away with after a pilot exercise in this context is completed. The measure is soon expected to be operationalised across Indian airports, they said.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Bihar: Bus ploughs into crowd, 5 killed Several injured, one critical

MPOST BUREAU
Patna, August 22

At least five people were killed and several others were injured, including one critically, when a bus ploughed through a crowd attending a cultural programme in Bihar's West Champaran district, police said on Saturday.

The incident took place around 10.45 pm on Friday along the Lauriya Marg in Parau Tola under the jurisdiction of Lauriya police station.

"While trying to avert a head-on collision with a truck, the bus ploughed through a crowd attending a cultural event on the roadside, killing five men and injuring several others," Narkatiyaganj Sub-divisional Police Officer (SDPO) Ajay Prakash Singh said.

The Bettiah-bound bus was coming from Gorakhpur in Uttar Pradesh.

The incident led to a stampede-like situation at the event, he added.

The deceased have been identified as Bahadur Mahto, Sanjay Kumar, Bhola Dubey, Devender Dubey and Jhangur Ram. The cultural programme was held on the occasion of 'chhathi' (an after-birth ritual) of Devender Dubey's daughter.

The critically injured person is undergoing treatment at a medical facility in Lauriya. The bodies have been **CONTINUED ON P4**

IOC TO MEET ENTIRE IMPORT REQUIREMENT

India, Mauritius deepen energy ties with 5-year fuel supply agreement

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 22

India and Mauritius have deepened their energy partnership with a five-year agreement under which Indian Oil Corporation will supply the island nation's entire import requirement of petrol, diesel and aviation turbine fuel (ATF), strengthening New Delhi's role as a key energy-security partner in the Indian Ocean.

The agreement was exchanged during Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri's official visit to Mauritius on August 20-21, alongside a government-to-government memorandum of understanding (MoU) to expand cooperation in oil and gas, including petroleum product supplies, training and capacity building, and biofuels.

The long-term sales and purchase agreement between IOC and Mauritius' State Trading Corporation is designed to provide Mauritius with assured supplies and reduce its exposure to price volatility, an official



statement said.

This, it said, was the first long-term supply agreement concluded by an Indian public-sector oil marketing company outside South Asia in recent years.

Under the pact, "IOC will supply the entire import requirement of Mauritius of motor spirit (petrol), high speed diesel (diesel) and ATF."

Separately, IOC said the 27,500 tonne bunker fuel storage facility at MAP Land in Mer Rouge, Mauritius has been built at an investment of \$25 million. "The facility will significantly boost IOML's bunkering capabilities and Mauritius' ambitions as a strategic bunkering hub. As Mauritius charts new horizons in its Blue Economy, IndianOil is proud to power the journey ahead."

The agreement comes as countries seek to strengthen energy security against disruptions in global fuel markets, particularly amid continuing instability in the West Asia region.

India, which has emerged as a major refining hub, produces about 267 million tonne of refined petroleum products annually from 23 refineries and

KEY POINTS

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is a net exporter of refined fuels. It already supplies petroleum products to neighbouring Nepal and Bhutan and exports significant volumes to other markets in the region and beyond.

The ministry said India continued to meet its supply commitments to Nepal and Bhutan even during the ongoing West Asia crisis, underscoring its position as a reliable supplier to the region.

"The agreement with Mauritius positions India as the country's anchor fuel supplier and strengthens India's strategic and economic footprint in the Indian Ocean region," the ministry statement said.

The pact also institutionalised the broader energy relationship between India and Mauritius, with the MoU providing a framework for cooperation across conventional fuels and emerging areas such as biofuels.

Puri met Mauritius Prime Minister Navinchandra Ramgoolam on August 20, with the two sides exchanging the oil and gas MoU and witnessing the IOC-STC agreement.

During the visit, Puri also held meetings with Energy and Public Utilities Minister Patrick Gervais Assirvaden, Commerce and Consumer Protection Minister John Michael Tzoun Sao Yeung Sik Yuen, and Foreign Affairs, Regional Integration and International Trade Minister Dhananjay Ramful. Puri & Assirvaden also participated in a groundbreaking ceremony for India Oil (Mauritius) Ltd's 27,500-tonne marine bunker fuel storage facility at Mer Rouge in Port Louis.

India must become an AI creator, not just consumer, says Delhi CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Vellore, August 22

India must transform itself into a creator of artificial intelligence (AI) rather than remain a consumer, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said at the 41st convocation of VIT University, Vellore, on Saturday.

Chief guest Gupta, who conferred degrees, said government-graduate partnerships could address pollution, traffic and waste management. "Don't just be users of artificial intelligence – build India's own AI," she said, citing Prime Minister Narendra Modi's India AI Mission covering semiconductors, computing infrastructure, defence, space, drones, robotics and biotechnology. She urged students to embrace resilience, hard work and "Make in India," "Invest in India," "Design in India" and "Brand in India."

VIT Chancellor G Viswanathan said India's Gross Enrolment Ratio in higher education is around 30 per cent & the NEP aims to raise it to 50 per cent. He cited 90 per cent in South Korea, 60 per cent in Japan, over 60 per cent in China, 40 per cent in Malaysia and 45 per cent in Thailand.



He said India has around 1,400 universities, 54,000 colleges, 16,000 stand-alone educational institutions and about 4.5 crore higher-education students. He said 22 lakh students appear for NEET annually for around 1.3 lakh medical seats, leaving barely 2,000 to 3,000 vacant. Nearly 1 lakh Indians go abroad annually for medical studies, including 23,000 in China, 18,000 in Russia, 15,000 in the Philippines, 10,000 each in Kyrgyzstan & France, 9,000 in Bangladesh, 7,500 in Georgia, 5,000 each in Italy and Poland and 3,000 each in Iran and Nepal.

India's 840 medical colleges offer 1.3 lakh seats, with institutions typically admitting 100 to 150 students, against up to 400 in Britain and 800 to 1,200 in China. Raising intake to 1,000 could help India reach 8 lakh seats, he said.

He also urged Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi to address vice-chancellor appointment issues, noting vacancies in 17 universities in Tamil Nadu & over 13 in Kerala. A personal moment came as Gupta's son, Nikunj Gupta, graduated with his batchmates. Gupta watched proudly as he received his degree.

In all, 11,276 students received degrees – 7,359 undergraduate and 3,917 postgraduate. They included 6,046 B.Tech, 1,732 M.Tech, 1,313 other undergraduate and 2,185 M.Sc. and other postgraduate students. Additionally, 781 received Ph.D. degrees and three integrated Ph.D. degrees; 248 received academic distinction certificates and 84 received gold medals.

Earlier, Gupta inaugurated a Centre for Advanced Research for Bacteriophage and Infectious Diseases.

PNGRB allows 1,800-km LPG pipeline network in ₹7K cr push for energy security

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 22

Oil sector regulator has authorised the development of nearly 1,800 km of new LPG pipelines at an estimated investment of Rs 7,000 crore, expanding the country's common-carrier LPG pipeline network by almost a quarter as it seeks to make fuel supplies more resilient and reduce dependence on road transport.

The Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB) has approved three strategically important LPG pipeline projects across Telangana, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Karnataka and Goa, the regulator said in a statement.

The projects, to be developed by state-run GAIL (India) Ltd, will take the PNGRB-authorised common-carrier LPG pipeline network from about 7,700 km to nearly 9,500 km, an increase of around 23.5 per cent.

The expansion comes as India relies heavily on imported LPG, with bulk supplies arriving at coastal import terminals and then being transported to consumption centres across the country.

A larger pipeline network is expected to improve the efficiency and reliability of moving LPG inland. The three newly authorised projects are 556-km Cherlapally (Telangana) to Nagpur (Maharashtra) line, 611-km Jhansi (Uttar Pradesh) to Sitarganj (Uttarakhand) pipeline and 633-km Shikrapur (Maharashtra) to Goa and Hubli (Karnataka) line.

The projects build on

the earlier authorisation of the 2,757-km Kandla-Gorakhpur LPG pipeline, the longest LPG pipeline in the country.

PNGRB said the new infrastructure would help accelerate a shift away from road-based transportation of LPG to pipelines, reducing the movement of LPG tankers and improving road safety while cutting logistics costs, traffic congestion and carbon emissions. Pipeline transportation is considered a safer and more economical mode of moving LPG over long distances.

Market regulator Sebi is reviewing the framework for monitoring and disclosing utilisation of issue proceeds to improve timely disclosures and streamline the compliance process, Sebi Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Saturday.

Addressing the Institute of Directors' Annual Directors' Conclave 2026, Pandey said transparency is not merely about the volume of information disclosed by a company but about whether the information helps investors understand what matters. "We are reviewing the framework for monitoring and disclosure of utilisation of issue proceeds, with the objective of improving timely disclosures and streamlining the compliance process," Pandey said.

He said a company making a disclosure does not necessarily mean it has become transparent.

"True transparency is not the volume of information. It is the quality, timeliness and usefulness of information," the Sebi chairman said.

Pandey said the regulator has progressively strengthened the framework for disclosure of material events and information, with materiality thresholds and specified timelines aimed at bringing greater consistency and timeliness to disclosures.

He also said Sebi proposes to further clarify the framework governing related-party transactions. "We propose to further clarify the framework on related-party transactions, so that the requirements are clear and workable for issuers while retaining the necessary safeguards for investors," Pandey said.

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Sebi reviewing framework for disclosure of issue proceeds utilisation: Chairman

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 22

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Concessional swap facility attracts \$72.84 bn forex inflows, says RBI

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 22

The Reserve Bank on Saturday said its concessional swap facility, introduced to encourage foreign currency inflows, has attracted \$72.84 billion till August 21.

Of the total inflows, the Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) or FCNR (B) deposits accounted for \$65.397 billion, while Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs) contributed \$4.86 billion and External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs) amounted to \$2.591 billion.

Last week, the Reserve Bank advanced the closure of the Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) swap window by a month to August 31.

Earlier, the cut-off date was September 30.

The scheme for ECBs and OFCBs will continue to be open till December 31, 2026, as hitherto.

The concessional swap facility was operationalised on June 8, 2026.

The measures were announced as part of the RBI's efforts to strengthen India's external sector position and support foreign exchange liquidity amid global market uncertainties.

Equity Mutual Fund AUM hits record ₹48.5 lakh crore in July

Active equity schemes registered 13.3% y-o-y growth & accounted for nearly 78% of total equity AUM

ANI NEWS

Mumbai, August 22

Equity mutual fund assets rose to a fresh record of Rs 48.5 lakh crore in July, accounting for 56 per cent of the mutual fund industry's overall Average Assets Under Management (AAUM), as active equity schemes continued to see strong growth, according to the NSE Market Pulse report for August.

The report said equity AUM had risen steadily after moderating in March

2026, with active equity schemes registering 13.3 per cent year-on-year growth and accounting for nearly 78 per cent of total equity AUM. Their share of the overall mutual fund industry's AAUM also reached 44 per cent.

"Equity and hybrid AAUM scale fresh highs in July," the NSE report said, highlighting the continued expansion of equity-oriented mutual fund assets.

Within open-ended equity schemes, flexi-cap funds held the largest

CLOSER LOOK

- » Within open-ended equity schemes, flexi-cap funds held the largest share of assets at 15.6%, followed by thematic funds at 14.6%, mid-cap funds at 13.6% and small-cap funds at 11.5%. Together, these four categories accounted for more than 55 per cent of equity Assets Under Management
- » Monthly SIP contributions stood at Rs 31,961 crore in July, remaining above Rs 30,000 crore for the fifth consecutive month. Cumulative SIP contributions in the first four months of FY27 reached Rs 1.3 lakh crore, up 15.4 per cent year-on-year

share of assets at 15.6 per cent, followed by thematic funds at 14.6 per cent, mid-cap funds at 13.6 per cent

and small-cap funds at 11.5 per cent. Together, these four categories accounted for more than 55 per cent

of equity AUM.

The report also pointed to continued investor participation through systematic investment plans (SIPs). Monthly SIP contributions stood at Rs 31,961 crore in July, remaining above Rs 30,000 crore for the fifth consecutive month. Cumulative SIP contributions in the first four months of FY27 reached Rs 1.3 lakh crore, up 15.4 per cent year-on-year.

SIP assets crossed Rs 18 lakh crore for the first

time, reaching Rs 18.2 lakh crore in July and accounting for 21.1 per cent of the mutual fund industry's overall assets. The report said this reflected the "sustained pace of investor participation."

Meanwhile, passive funds also reached a fresh record, with AAUM rising to Rs 15.5 lakh crore, up 23.3 per cent year-on-year. Equity passive funds accounted for nearly 68 per cent of passive assets, while gold and silver ETFs also recorded strong

growth.

In contrast, debt fund AAUM declined 0.4 per cent year-on-year to Rs 21.7 lakh crore, mainly due to a sharp contraction in passive debt funds, while active debt assets remained broadly subdued.

With equity AUM, SIP assets and passive funds all at record levels, the report's July data points to continued expansion of the mutual fund industry's equity-oriented segment, while debt assets remain comparatively subdued.



NEW DELHI	
Temp on	Saturday
MAX 35.2°C	MIN 25.3°C

FORECAST

TOD leasehold plots to get freehold status

MPD-2047: Move to ease property ownership

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 22

An individual plot identified in the Transit Oriented Development (TOD) corridor can be converted into freehold under the Master Plan of Delhi-2047, in a bid to encourage private-sector participation among other objectives.

The freehold status accords absolute and complete ownership of the land in question and also of the structure upon it, as opposed to the lease model under which a governing authority, such as the DDA, would retain the ownership of the land while allowing its use by the leaseholder.

As per the master plan, the entire TOD zone shall be declared as a Development Area to fast-track the approval of projects in the corridor.

“Individual plots forming part of a consolidated TOD plot, held on a leasehold basis, shall be deemed freehold, except institutional plots on leasehold, subject to clearance of all dues,” the Master Plan of Delhi (MPD) states.

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) shall be the nodal authority for approval of TOD projects and sanctioning of building plans, it adds.

Many properties in Delhi are currently on a leasehold basis, which means ownership belongs



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

IN SHORT

- » Many properties in Delhi are currently on a leasehold basis, which means ownership belongs to the DDA. But the MPD-2027 paves the way for freehold ownership, free from leasing
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Another feature of the MPD is the availability of multiple development models, which is expected to give landowners greater flexibility to participate in planned development while ensuring timely execution of infrastructure.

“Under MPD-2047, roads with a width of 30 metres and above will be notified and developed directly by DDA. The new urban areas will be developed as self-contained neighbourhoods with schools, healthcare facilities, parks and green spaces, commercial centres and other public amenities, ensuring that housing growth is matched with quality-of-life infrastructure,” the DDA said.

IIT-D student jumps from sixth floor, dies

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 22

A 31-year-old MSc Physics student at IIT Delhi died after allegedly jumping from sixth floor of a campus building on Saturday morning here, police said.

The officer said no suicide note was recovered from the scene, adding that a mobile phone found in the deceased’s pocket would be examined. Prima facie, police said no injury marks other than those attributable to the fall were found on the body.

As part of the investigation, police are obtaining the student’s counselling



records and other relevant information from the institute. Police said they are examining the circumstances leading to the student’s death and verifying all available information.

Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi in a statement said, “The institute deeply mourns the tragic and untimely demise of an

PRIMA FACIE, POLICE SAID NO INJURY MARKS OTHER THAN THOSE ATTRIBUTABLE TO THE FALL WERE FOUND ON THE BODY

MSc student on August 22. The Delhi Police are investigating the sad incident. Our deepest thoughts and prayers are with the bereaved family. The institute is providing them with all support.”

According to a preliminary enquiry, the deceased entered the IIT Delhi campus through the main gate

Rs 75L daylight heist cracked

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 22

A woman was tied up, gagged and held at knife-point inside her Ashok Vihar home as a gang of robbers ransacked the house for nearly half an hour, but a month-long recce and a carefully planned escape came undone after police tracked the suspects across Delhi, Uttar Pradesh and Punjab.

Six men and two juveniles have been apprehended in connection with the August 19 daylight robbery in which around Rs 75 lakh in cash and valuables were allegedly looted, with police recovering Rs 51.52 lakh and three mobile phones worth around Rs 2.33 lakh. Police said one of the minors emerged as the alleged mastermind.

Speaker Gupta calls for stronger university role in policymaking

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 22

Good laws require sound facts, credible research and ground-level evidence, and universities must become active partners in providing such knowledge to legislatures and governments, Delhi Legislative Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta said on Saturday.

Addressing the inaugural ceremony of the Vice Chancellors’ Conclave 2026 at Manav Rachna International Institute of Research and Studies, Faridabad, Gupta said legislatures make laws, approve budgets and hold governments accountable, while universities can strengthen the process through research-based inputs, expert opinions on environmental legislation and greater student



engagement with democratic institutions.

Calling the conclave “a resolve”, Gupta said climate change was no longer a distant threat but a present reality, with record heat, winter smog, polluted air, sudden flooding and declining groundwater levels being witnessed across Delhi and the National Capital Region.

The two-day conclave, being held on August 22-23, is themed “Green Campus:

around 8 am, then went to the Lecture Hall Complex and took a lift to the sixth floor. He then allegedly jumped from the front side of the building, a senior officer said.

Police said the student was rushed to IIT Delhi’s campus hospital, where he was declared brought dead. A PCR call regarding the incident was received around 8:30 am at Kishangarh police station, following which a police team reached the IIT Delhi campus.

Police said a crime team and a forensic science laboratory (FSL) unit were called to collect evidence.

Whitewashing work turns deadly labourer falls to death

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 22

A 44-year-old labourer was killed and another injured after the two allegedly fell from a height while carrying out whitewashing work at a property in Delhi’s Fateh Nagar, police said on Saturday.

A PCR call was received by the police on Friday regarding two labourers falling from a height while working at the site, following which a police team rushed to the spot, they said.

Both injured men had already been shifted to hospitals by the time the police reached the site, an officer said.

The crime team and Forensic Science Laboratory (FSL) team inspected the spot as part of the investigation, police said.

One of the labourers, Munna Shah, was taken to Deen Dayal Upadhyay where he was declared brought dead. The other labourer, Rajesh, was admitted to Dashmesh Hospital with grievous injuries. He was unable to give his statement, they said.

According to the police, the preliminary investigation, including scene inspection and medical evidence, indicated that the two men had fallen from a height while carrying out whitewashing work without adequate safety measures.

A case has been registered at Hari Nagar police station and further investigation is underway.

Briefs

Seven of family hurt in wall collapse

GURUGRAM: Seven members of a family, three children among them, were injured on Saturday after an under-construction wall collapsed and its debris trapped them while they were sleeping, police said. The family, comprising natives of Patna district in Bihar, was in Gurugram for employment as labourers at a tile manufacturing factory located in Sector 84, police said.

151 held in four-day crackdown

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested and apprehended 151 people during a four-day enforcement drive in east Delhi targeting street crime, illegal arms, drugs, gambling and other criminal activities, an officer said on Saturday.

“Operation Aaghat” was conducted from August 17 to 20 across the district, with police teams carrying out intensive patrolling, vehicle checking, surveillance.

18 foreigners detained

NEW DELHI: Eighteen foreign nationals, including nine from Thailand, four from Nigeria and three from Bangladesh, have been apprehended for allegedly overstaying in India during a verification drive in Delhi’s Outer District, police said on Saturday.

Pay parity for 4,400 MTS workers, but MCD sanitation woes remain

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 22

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi’s decision to extend “same pay for same work” benefits to 4,400 contractual Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS) employees working in the Public Health Department has brought cheer among workers, but the move also comes against the backdrop of a persistent shortage of sanitation personnel across the city.

The MCD Public Health Department, in an office order, said the contractual MTS workers would receive minimum Level-1 pay of ₹18,000, along with variable dearness allowance as applicable under



the Seventh Central Pay Commission, prospectively against relevant heads of account. The arrangement will be implemented after execution of fresh annual contracts.

The decision prompted scores of employees to visit the MCD headquarters, where they garlanded

Mayor Pravesh Wahi and offered sweets. The workers described the move, backed by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and the Mayor, as a long-pending demand finally being addressed.

However, the Corporation continues to grapple with another challenge an uneven distribution and shortage of sanitation workers. MCD Standing Committees member Satya Sharma said the Corporation was not opposed to regularising workers or questioning their demands, but stressed that workers must remain present at their assigned beats so that the workload does not fall disproportionately on colleagues.

“There are areas where the requirement for sanitation workers is much higher, while some places have more workers than needed,” Sharma said, attributing the overall shortage partly to retirements and deaths among workers and Delhi’s steadily growing population.

She said workers should be deployed across wards according to the population and sanitation needs of each locality. The twin developments better pay and rational deployment underline a larger requirement: ensuring that Delhi’s sanitation workforce is both adequately compensated and adequately staffed.

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 22

With vector-borne diseases posing a seasonal challenge, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi on Saturday launched its ‘Anti-Dengue Month’ awareness programme in Rohini Sector-8, with Mayor Pravesh Wahi stressing that preventing mosquito breeding remains the most effective way to control dengue, malaria and chikungunya.

Inaugurating the programme, Wahi said stagnant water around homes and public spaces must be eliminated at source. He said Aedes mosquitoes breed in accumulated clean water found in coolers, drums, tins, flower pots, money-plant con-



tainers, overhead tanks and bird baths.

The Mayor urged residents to regularly inspect their surroundings and ensure that water does not remain stagnant, calling for greater public participation in preventing mosquito breeding.

As part of the preventive measures, Wahi directed the MCD Public Health Department to undertake fogging at religious

places, including temples and gurdwaras, across the North-West Zone during the coming week. The programme also featured an exhibition highlighting measures for the prevention and control of vector-borne diseases. Councillor Narendra Solanki, North-West Zone Deputy Commissioner Anshul Sirohi, Deputy Health Officer Dr. Kanika, RWA representatives, municipal staff and residents attended the event.

Meanwhile, Mayor Pravesh Wahi on Saturday participated in a two-kilometre mega march in Prashant Vihar as part of the MCD’s ‘Delhi Ko Koode Se Azaadi’ campaign aimed at promoting cleanliness and public participation.

Delhi pollution: A danger beyond lungs

‘Research links particulate-matter exposure with cognitive decline’

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 22

For Delhiites, the health cost of breathing polluted air may go beyond coughing, breathlessness and heart problems, with a Delhi University review suggesting that prolonged exposure to fine particulate matter (PM2.5) could also affect the brain.

Studies reviewed by DU professors have linked long-term exposure to particulate matter with changes in brain structure, memory, attention and other cognitive functions.

Researchers said PM2.5 can trigger inflammation and oxidative stress, affect the energy-producing system of brain cells and interfere with the blood-brain barrier, which normally protects the brain from harmful substances.

Some of the smallest

KEY POINTS

- » Studies reviewed by DU professors have linked long-term exposure to particulate matter with changes in brain structure, memory, attention and other cognitive functions
- » Researchers said PM2.5 can trigger inflammation and oxidative stress, affect the energy-producing system of brain cells and interfere with the blood-brain barrier, which normally protects the brain from harmful substances



particles may also reach the central nervous system through the nose and the olfactory pathway, the review said.

The review, conducted by DU professors from the Department of Environmental Studies, examined 129 peer-reviewed articles on the neurological effects of particulate matter and found growing evidence linking long-term exposure to PM2.5 with cog-

nitive impairment and structural and functional changes in the brain. “Air pollution is no longer only a lung and heart problem; it is increasingly a brain-health problem. Research now links long-term particulate-matter exposure with cognitive decline, impaired neurodevelopment and biological processes associated with Alzheimer’s and Parkinson’s diseases,” Vandana Mishra, one of

the researchers associated with the study, said.

Mishra added that fine particulate matter has even been seen to breach the blood-brain barrier, a dangerous side effect of pollution.

One key concern highlighted in the review is that prolonged exposure to air pollution has been associated with changes in the physical structure of the brain.

“A growing body of evidence strongly demonstrates that chronic exposure to ambient air pollution, particularly PM, leads to region-specific structural and functional alterations in the human brain, spanning across developmental and ageing stages,” the study says.

Neuroimaging and other studies have reported reductions in brain volume and cortical thickness, particularly in areas such as the frontal and temporal lobes that are involved in cognition.

These structural changes have been associated with problems in memory, attention and executive functions such as planning and decision-making, the study adds.

The review also cites evidence of changes in the hippocampus, a region important for memory.

City logs maximum of 35.2 deg C; light rain likely on Sunday

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 22

The national capital on Saturday recorded a maximum temperature of 35.2 degrees Celsius, one degree above the normal and 0.6 degree lower than Friday, after logging a minimum temperature over 3 degrees lower than the day before.

Safdarjung, representative of the city’s weather, recorded a minimum temperature of 25.3 degrees Celsius, 1.2 degree below the normal and with a 3.1-degrees decrease from Friday.

The maximum of 35.2 degrees Celsius was one degree above the normal and 0.6 degree lower than the day before.

The maximum temperature at Lodhi Road and Ayanagar were respec-

tively 35.2 degrees and 34.8 degrees Celsius.

Palam recorded a minimum temperature of 23.7 degrees Celsius, 1.9 degree lower than the day before and a maximum of 34.2 degrees; Lodhi

Road recorded a minimum of 25.8 degrees Celsius and Ayanagar 25.2 degrees, with a 2.1-degrees decrease from Friday.

No significant rain was recorded on Saturday.

IMD has forecast very light rain on Sunday.

“There is a possibility of very light rain or drizzle to occur at several places of the city on Sunday,” an IMD official said.

According to the IMD forecast, the maximum is likely to be around 36 degrees Celsius and the minimum about 25 degrees Celsius on Sunday.

Himachal: 111
lives lost to
rain, natural
disasters

AGENCIES
Shimla, August 22

Heavy rains and natural disasters have caused widespread damage in Himachal Pradesh in the financial year 2026, and 111 people have died as a result, according to Revenue Minister Jagat Singh Negi.

In a written reply to a question from BJP MLA Vipin Singh Parmar on Saturday, the minister said that the state recorded an average rainfall of 109.80 millimetres over the past five months.

Noting that three cloud-burst incidents were also reported during this period, he added that these natural disasters have resulted in significant damage to lives, property, houses, roads, bridges, drinking water schemes, power infrastructure, and other basic amenities.

The minister further informed that relief funds have been distributed to 1,871 affected families in the state so far, while 1,260 families have not yet received compensation.

He said that in most of the pending cases, affected families had not applied for relief through the RMS portal. In some instances, applications were incomplete.

He assured that eligible families would receive relief funds as soon as the necessary formalities were completed.

MUMBAI MONORAIL SCARE

Meghalaya assures Assam travellers of safety, regrets Shillong violence

MPOST BUREAU
Guwahati, August 22

The Meghalaya government on Saturday expressed regret over the violence during a recent students' rally in Shillong, in which Assam residents were allegedly targeted, and assured the safety of travellers, according to a joint statement issued by both states after a ministerial-level meeting here.

The governments of Assam and Meghalaya decided on short- and long-term measures to ease the situation and urged people to cooperate in restoring normalcy.

The statement, issued during a joint press briefing by Meghalaya Deputy Chief Minister S Dhar and Assam Border Protection and Development Minister Atul Bora, said the Meghalaya government had expressed regret over the August 19 incident and assured the safety of people travelling to the hill state.

"The government of Meghalaya has sincerely regretted the unfortunate incident of August 19 in Shillong and assured to take strong action against those who are involved," it said.

The president, vice-president and general secretary of the Khasi Students' Union (KSU), which organised the rally during which the violence



Transporters block the Assam-Meghalaya border at Jorabat amid tensions following violence during a KSU motorcycle rally in Shillong, in Guwahati, Assam PTI

KEY POINTS

- » The governments of Assam and Meghalaya decided on short- and long-term measures to ease the situation and urged people to cooperate in restoring normalcy
- » The president, vice-president and general secretary of the Khasi Students' Union (KSU), which organised the rally during which the violence took place, have been arrested under the Meghalaya Maintenance of Public Order Act

ence took place, have been arrested under the Meghalaya Maintenance of Public Order Act.

Fifteen FIRs have so far been registered in connection with the incident, while five masked persons have been identified as allegedly

being involved, particularly in attacks on Assam-registered vehicles, the joint statement said.

The Meghalaya government said a Special Investigation Team (SIT) has been constituted to probe, identify and prosecute those

involved in the August 19 violence here, in which 16 people were injured, two vehicles set ablaze and around 31 vehicles damaged, the statement said.

It also said five masked men involved in the violence and random attacks on Assam-registered tourist vehicles have so far been identified.

More than 3,770 Assam-registered vehicles have already been safely escorted out of Meghalaya into Assam, it said.

The Assam Control Room has received 54 distress calls involving 175 people seeking assistance in evacuation. These include 22 pri-

vate vehicles and five tourist vehicles, the statement said.

The Meghalaya Control Room has received 379 distress calls, and steps have been taken to assist those stranded in making safe transit, it said.

Most stranded travellers and vehicles, including around 400-500 vehicles that were earlier held up in Meghalaya, have crossed key transit corridors, including the Umiam Lake section.

Any passenger or vehicle yet to be transferred to Assam will be safely escorted within the next 48 hours, the statement said.

"A dedicated exercise will be undertaken to ensure that every tourist or vehicle wishing to return to Assam is facilitated and safely escorted," the statement added.

The meeting decided to establish a dedicated coordination mechanism between the Inspector General, Special Branch, Assam, and the IG, Law and Order, Meghalaya, along with dedicated helplines. An online support forum will also be activated to assist in locating and facilitating stranded individuals, with the numbers 9181014888 (WhatsApp) and 0361-2381-511 (landline).

This mechanism shall remain operational until the situation is fully normalised, the statement added.

Flood-battered Odisha braces for another spell of heavy rain

Special Relief Commissioner asked all districts to remain fully alert and prepared

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Bhubaneswar, August 22

Odisha on Saturday braced for another spell of heavy rain as a fresh low-pressure area over the Bay of Bengal was in forecast, prompting the state government to step up preparedness in flood-affected districts.

The IMD said the low-pressure area is likely to form over the north Bay of Bengal, off the West Bengal-Bangladesh coasts, on Sunday.

Under its influence, Odisha is likely to receive isolated heavy to very heavy rainfall, including in several districts already affected by floods.

"The upper air cyclonic circulation over central Myanmar and the neighbourhood now lies over the north Bay of Bengal off the West Bengal-Bangladesh coasts. Under its influence, a low-pressure area is likely to form over the same region during the next 24 hours," the weather agency said.

Special Relief Commissioner (SRC) Rajesh P Patil asked all districts to remain fully alert and prepared to deal with any eventuality.

"The SRC Office along with the State Emer-



THE IMD SAID THE LOW-PRESSURE AREA IS LIKELY TO FORM OVER THE NORTH BAY OF BENGAL, OFF THE WEST BENGAL-BANGLADESH COASTS, ON SUNDAY

gency Operation Centre (SEOC) is maintaining round-the-clock monitoring of the situation in coordination with all District Emergency Operation Centres (DEOCs) across the state," Patil said.

He said the flood situation was under control as water levels in all major rivers had receded and were flowing well below the danger mark.

However, floodwater continued to affect 703 villages in four districts -- Balasore, Kendrapara, Bhadrak and Jajpur.

From page 1

Shah

aged 14 and above, who comprise the Gen Z and Gen Alpha generations, sources said.

The party has begun constituting dedicated teams comprising senior leaders from across the country. The Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha has been tasked with helping form and mobilise these teams.

Former national office-bearers will also be given a key role in the outreach programme, sources said.

The meeting also focused on preparations for upcoming state Assembly elections and strengthening the party's organisation at the grassroots.

Nabin will hold another organisational review meeting on Sunday where state BJP presidents, organisational general secretaries, and state in-charges from across the country will be present.

The party will review preparations for Assembly elections in Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Punjab, along with other poll-bound states. Leaders will also discuss party programmes and wider organisational issues.

The BJP also passed a resolution condemning the Congress Working Committee's decision to sing only the first two stanzas of Vande Mataram at party events. The resolution said the BJP would not accept any compromise on the honour and legacy of the national song for "political convenience or appeasement".

"A political compromise of 1937 cannot be elevated above the constitutional settlement of 1950 and legislation enacted by Parliament in 2026," the BJP president said.

Parliament on July 30 passed the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Act, 2026, granting Vande Mataram the same legal status as the national anthem, Jana Gana Mana.

Jaishankar

The external affairs min-

ister said India will have to do business with the entire world, including China, with confidence while continuing to stand its ground as it did along the frontier.

"I think we went through a particularly bad patch between the summer of 2020 and the autumn of 2024, and that was primarily an outcome of the situation in the border areas," he said at the Economic Times World Leaders Forum.

Jaishankar said that "at the end of the day, peace and tranquillity in the border areas is a prerequisite for good relations, and the state of the border, to a very large measure, naturally would determine the state of the relations."

The external affairs minister said the countries are "very big economies" and both countries are markets to each other in many ways as well as part of a supply chain.

"The world is competitive. We must build up our strengths. We have to do business with the entire world. That includes China too. But it is important we deal with them confidently and we stand our ground as we have stood in the border," he said.

Jaishankar's remarks came in response to a question on the state of India-China ties.

India and China rolled out a series of measures in the last over one year to rebuild their relationship after it came under severe strain following the deadly Galwan valley clashes in 2020 and the subsequent military face-off that lasted for more than four years.

Fare row

Rajinder allegedly assaulted him with bricks and an earthen-pot-like object, inflict fatal injuries, police said. After committing the crime, he called his wife, Kamini Makhija, 50, and son, Laksh Makhija, 28, to hide the body, police said.

The officer said the two allegedly assisted him in concealing the deceased's clothes and dealing with the vehicle used in the crime. All three were subsequently arrested on Friday night.

Police learned about the

incident when the Naraina police station received a PCR call about the body in the Naraina Vihar area, the officer said. Police reached the spot and found an unidentified man, aged around 35 years, lying naked and blood-stained on the pavement near the wall of a government school.

Police said the man suffered a deep injury on the right side of his head, along with multiple body injuries.

Blood scattered around the spot indicated a violent assault.

"Investigators also noticed a distinctive heart-shaped tattoo with an arrow on the victim's left forearm, bearing the names 'Anand' and 'Renu', which became an initial clue in establishing his identity," a senior police officer said.

The crime team and Forensic Science Laboratory team inspected the scene and collected evidence before shifting the body to Deen Dayal Upadhyay Hospital, where doctors declared him brought dead. After registering an FIR, police began the probe.

Because the deceased's identity was unknown and no eyewitnesses were apparent, police examined CCTV cameras installed around the crime scene and along roads leading to and from the area.

"Teams analysed around 500 CCTV recordings and noticed a Maruti Eeco moving suspiciously in the vicinity around the relevant time. The registration number was not initially clear, prompting police to track the vehicle through multiple cameras and reconstruct its route before and after the incident," the officer said.

Police eventually identified the vehicle as a Maruti Eeco and traced and apprehended its owner, Kumar, a resident of Naraina village. Police recovered the van at the instance of Kumar's wife Kamini, while they recovered the deceased's clothes and shoes following information provided by his son, Laksh.

Police said they are examining the vehicle as an important piece of evidence to establish the sequence of events leading to the killing and disposal of

the body. The officer said the deceased's identity has not yet been established, and further investigation is underway.

MP

Assembly Umang Singh targeted the BJP government in the state over the incident.

In a post on X, Singh alleged that hospitals were becoming a threat to lives under the BJP government and demanded an immediate fire safety audit of all hospitals in the state.

He also urged Chief Minister Mohan Yadav to ensure the safety of patients.

H1N1

People have also been advised to avoid touching their eyes and nose, refrain from spitting in public places and take adequate fluids.

If symptoms such as fever, cough, sore throat, breathing difficulty, body ache or headache appear seek medical advice instead of taking medicines without consulting a doctor, the advisory said.

The health department earlier said Delhi was fully prepared to deal with the seasonal rise in influenza cases, with adequate beds, doctors, medicines and essential medical equipment available in hospitals.

It said 35 hospitals have been kept under special surveillance and two referral laboratories have been designated at AIIMS and the National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC).

Technical guidelines covering patient categorisation, treatment protocols, ventilatory management, use of masks and home care have also been issued.

Advisories have been sent to chief district medical officers, district surveillance officers and hospitals regarding screening, reporting and monitoring of influenza-like illness (ILI), severe acute respiratory infection (SARI), influenza and COVID-19 cases on the Integrated Health Information Platform (IHIP) portal as per the guidelines.

Training and orientation of healthcare workers on the existing guidelines, signs and

symptoms of these illnesses and the required follow-up action are also being undertaken, the department said.

According to health department data, 159 influenza cases were reported on Thursday. Of these, 155 were Influenza-A cases, including 114 H1N1, two H1, one H3 and 38 other Influenza-A cases. Four Influenza-B cases were also reported.

The total number of influenza cases reported in Delhi this year stands at 2,602, including 2,392 Influenza-A and 210 Influenza-B cases till Friday.

Among the Influenza-A cases, 1,777 are H1N1, 37 H1, 138 H3 and 440 other cases. The Influenza-B tally includes 200 Victoria strain cases and 10 other cases.

Delhi Health Minister Pan-kaj Kumar Singh attended a meeting chaired by Union Health Minister J P Nadda on Friday to review Delhi's preparedness to deal with seasonal influenza and vector-borne diseases.

In an official statement issued after the meeting, Singh said there was no shortage of beds, doctors, medicines or essential medical equipment in the capital. He said the patient tally was being monitored and hospital arrangements were being strengthened according to requirements.

The health department earlier said the Delhi State Health Mission was keeping a close watch on the influenza situation through the Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme (IDSP) and monitoring morbidity and mortality linked to the infection.

The state surveillance unit is monitoring daily data on influenza, ILI and SARI cases reported through the IDSP-IHIP portal. A daily bulletin is generated and shared with higher authorities, the department said.

Tariff war

dairy, appliances, agricultural equipment, pulp and paper and electronics. Details of the specific products will be released in the coming days.

Carney, speaking in Ottawa, also disclosed that Canada had been willing to drop remaining retaliatory tariffs on steel, aluminium and autos if the United States substantially lowered its own, and to encourage provinces to restore US alcohol sales.

But he said Washington's final demands went too far, saying, "They asked too much and offered too little," Carney said.

"Tonight, Canada declined to finalize the trade deal under the terms agreed earlier this week. Despite the US offer to Canada to receive the best treatment of any major exporter to our market, new demands and walk-backs of other commitments by Canada have upended the careful balance reached in the past days," US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said in a statement read to reporters shortly before midnight.

Carney blamed the Republican administration for the breakdown, saying "last-minute changes in the US proposed terms were unfair, uneconomic, and called into question the reliability of any deal." He said he had suspended negotiations and directed Canada's negotiating team to return to Ottawa.

Carney said his government would announce additional support for Canadian workers and businesses in the coming days.

Greer said the US offer was "forward-looking" and included "a historic economic and national security partnership."

No further talks are planned.

The breakdown in negotiations marked a sharp reversal from two days earlier, when officials from the two countries sounded as if they were headed toward a compromise.

Carney said Canada's goal throughout the negotiations had been to secure the best possible agreement, "never a deal at any price or on any deadline."

The political impact will likely be even bigger than the economic fallout. The countries sold each other USD 880

billion worth of goods and services last year.

The tariffs were initially supposed to kick in at 12:01 am Wednesday. Trump extended the deadline for three days to allow talks to continue, but the countries could not reach an agreement in time.

The US and Canada have wrangled for decades over trade, poking each other over sore spots such as Canadian softwood lumber imports and US access to Canada's protected dairy market.

Somehow, they still managed to remain friends, allies and trading partners. Canadian soldiers fought alongside Americans in Afghanistan after 9/11. The 5,525-mile US-Canada border is undefended, and nearly 330,000 people and USD 2 billion worth of goods cross it every day; 800,000 Canadians live in the United States.

Trump has imposed tariffs on Canadian goods in a push to bring manufacturing back to the United States and made inflammatory comments about turning Canada into America's 51st state.

Carney said Canada had recognized that "America has changed" and that the two countries would "not return to our old relationship."

Bihar

sent for post-mortem examination, the officer said.

"The bus and the truck have been seized, while their drivers fled the spot taking advantage of the chaos," he said, adding a manhunt has been launched for them.

Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary expressed grief over the deaths and offered condolences to the bereaved family members.

"The news of the death of several people in the Lauriya police station area of West Champaran district is extremely tragic. May God give a place to the departed souls in his feet and provide enough strength to the kin to brave the loss," he said in a social media post.

He also directed officials to ensure proper treatment of the people injured in the incident.

TARGETS CONGRESS OVER TWO-STANZA PRACTICE

BJP vows to protect legacy of ‘Vande Mataram’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 22

In a political statement regarding the legacy of Vande Mataram, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Saturday adopted a resolution promising to protect the honour, dignity and historical legacy of the National Song and launching an attack on the Congress for maintaining the practice of singing just its first two stanzas during party functions.

The resolution attempts to place the issue of Vande Mataram in the broader context of India's national consciousness, struggle for freedom, and politics.

Apart from the attack on the Congress Working Committee (CWC), the BJP has announced that it will launch a nationwide movement to educate people about the history and six-stanza legacy of the song, particularly the youth of the country.

BJP also condemned the decision taken by the working committee of its main rival Congress to restrict it to its first two stanzas.

The saffron party believes that this was done with the motive of reducing the status of the National Song.

As per the official communiqué, the National Song represents respect towards Bharat Mata, the spirit of the freedom strug-



BJP leaders during party president Nitin Nabin's first meeting with the party's newly appointed national office-bearers, at party headquarters, in New Delhi, Saturday

CLOSER LOOK

- » The resolution attempts to place the issue of Vande Mataram in the broader context of India's national consciousness, struggle for freedom, and politics
- » The resolution made a reference to the part played by the song Vande Mataram, authored by novelist and poet Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay

gle and the eternal expres-

sion of Indian national consciousness. The resolution made a reference to the part played by the song Vande Mataram, authored by novelist and poet Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay, in the process of building the Indian national movement.

The document noted that the song had grown into an embodiment of patriotic feelings and had been used

as a slogan of struggle during the Swadeshi movement that started after the partition of Bengal in 1905.

According to the BJP, the increasing popularity of the song as a means of struggle against colonial oppression led the British rulers to try to ban it.

It should also be noted that the BJP tried to put the discussion on singing the song in its political context of the 1930s.

In particular, the resolution mentioned the decision adopted by the Congress Working Committee on October 28, 1937, according to which the song would be sung only with two out of the six stanzas on national occasions.

The BJP claimed that this decision was due to objections about the religious content of the latter stanzas.

The resolution also made mention of the political events of the time, such as the complaints of the Muslim League and the correspondence between MA Jinnah and Jawaharlal Nehru.

The BJP claimed that these political events were part of the history of the situation in which the full singing of Vande Mataram was restricted.

Cong accuses govt of taking no steps to control inflation

Targets govt over rise in commodity prices

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 22

The Congress on Saturday accused the Modi government of not taking any steps to control rising prices of essential commodities and said the public will “remember this and will not forgive”.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge raised the issue of rising sugar prices in the last few months and asked whether the use of sugarcane for producing ethanol for E20 blending was responsible for it.

Posing three questions to the government, he asked why sugar stocks are at their lowest in the last nine years, who is responsible for the rise in sugar prices ahead of festivals and whether the E20 policy should be reviewed in view of the high sugar prices.

“Before the festivals, the bitterness of the Modi government's policies has



seeped into the sweetness of sugar. Three direct questions to the Modi government:

“Why is the sugar stock in India, the world's largest sugar producer and exporter, at its lowest level in 9 years today? How did we reach the point of halting exports and importing one million tons of sugar duty-free?” Kharge asked in a post on X.

Claiming that sugar has become nearly 40 per cent more expensive in three months, he asked who was responsible for this burden on the public just before the festivals.

“When there is a shortage of sugar in the coun-

KHARGE RAISED THE ISSUE OF RISING SUGAR PRICES IN THE LAST FEW MONTHS AND ASKED WHETHER THE USE OF SUGARCANE FOR PRODUCING ETHANOL FOR E20 BLENDING WAS RESPONSIBLE FOR IT

try and the government is importing sugar from abroad, why isn't the policy of diverting sugarcane and grain to produce Ethanol for E20 being reviewed?

“What kind of ‘self-reliant India’ is this? First, sugar production declined, then stocks reached their lowest level in 9 years, now we're importing sugar from abroad - and on the other hand, we're throwing sugarcane into Ethanol to blend with petrol,” the Congress chief said in his post.

BJP means ‘Bhag Jao Pakistan’: Akhilesh

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, August 22

Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav on Saturday hit back at Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath over his remark that the “P” in PDA could one day stand for Pakistan, saying if the chief minister could redefine PDA, he could also give a new meaning to BJP.

“Yogi ji is saying that P in PDA stands for Pakistan. Then I will say BJP means

‘Bhag Jao Pakistan,’” Akhilesh said, while attacking the CM over his remarks.

He said the more the BJP's “pain” increased, the stronger the PDA would become. “The greater their pain, the further PDA will advance. PDA also means ‘Prem, Daya, Apnapan’ (love, compassion and belonging). The more we Samajwadis bring people together with love, compassion and belonging, the stronger the Samajwadi

Party will become. In the future, it will form a historic govt,” he said.

Akhilesh also accused the BJP government of misusing power and alleged that corruption and the diversion of govt funds had become its main agenda.

He alleged that people belonging to the PDA social grouping were being subjected to harassment and claimed that fake encounters were taking place in the state.

CM orders crackdown on sugar hoarding, black marketing in UP

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, August 22

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Saturday reviewed the availability of sugar in Uttar Pradesh and directed officials to take strict action against hoarding and black marketing, particularly ahead of the new sugarcane crushing season beginning October 15.

The state currently has 179.38 lakh quintals of sugar available with sugar mills. Of this, cooperative sugar mills have 23.60 lakh quintals, corporation-run mills have 5.28 lakh quintals and private sugar mills have 150.50 lakh quintals in stock.

During the review, Yogi directed officials to ensure that sugar dealers do not hold stocks beyond the prescribed period. No dealer will be allowed to store sugar for more than 30 days, officials were told.

The chief minister also

ordered action against dealers found holding more than 400 tonnes of sugar at a time.

Officials have been asked to regularly monitor stocks and take action against those attempting to create an artificial shortage or manipulate prices through excessive stocking.

Strict action under the Essential Services Maintenance Act will be taken against those violating the prescribed norms, according to the directions issued during the review.

The govt has stepped up monitoring of sugar availability as the state prepares for the new crushing season. Sugar mills are scheduled to begin crushing operations from October 15.

Yogi also reviewed the payment of sugarcane dues to farmers and highlighted the payments made during the current period.

Punjab CM only passing time by cracking jokes, alleges Nayab Saini

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, August 22

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini said that Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann is merely passing his time by cracking jokes.

He asked Bhagwant Mann to explain what happened to the promises made by the Aam Aadmi Party to women and youth during the last elections.

“The Aam Aadmi Party had promised to provide Rs 1,000 every month to women, and nearly five years of the government's tenure have passed, with the next elections now around the corner. Yet, the Punjab Chief Minister is still asking women from the stage whether he should deposit one month's money, two months' money or three months' money into their account. What else can this be if not a joke? Similarly, due to the poor law-and-order situation, industries are migrating from Punjab, creating an employment crisis for the youth, while frustrated and disappointed youngsters are increasingly falling into the trap

DAY AFTER DEADLY SHOPPING MALL DRONE STRIKE BY MOSCOW

Russian & Ukrainian attacks kill 10

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Kyiv, August 22

Russian drone and missile strikes killed at least seven people in Ukraine, officials said Saturday, while a Ukrainian drone attack on Russia's Krasnodar region killed three people there.

The attacks came a day after a Russian strike on a Ukrainian shopping centre killed at least 16 people and wounded some 130.

Moscow's forces have recently intensified their ballistic missile attacks on Kyiv, exploiting Ukraine's chronic shortage of US-made Patriot air defence interceptors, the sole weapon in its arsenal able to shoot down the missiles.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said that one person was killed and another wounded in the latest attacks when ballistic missiles hit railway infrastructure in the capital, Kyiv, overnight.

Russia's Defence Ministry said that its forces had hit a locomotive depot.

In a separate attack,



local authorities said two people were killed Saturday afternoon in a Russian ballistic missile strike on the Kyiv region, which surrounds the capital.

Russian drone strikes also killed one person overnight in the Zaporizhzhia region, local officials said Saturday, and a daytime attack killed three others and wounded 15. Zelenskyy said that three people were also wounded in an attack on a minibus in the regional capital, also called Zaporizhzhia.

In Russia's southern Krasnodar region, authorities said that three people, including two children, were killed and two adults were wounded in a Ukrainian drone strike.

The latest attacks came a day after Russian drones struck a shopping centre in the city of Kryvyi Rih in central Ukraine.

Dnipropetrovsk regional head Oleksandr Hanzha said in the early hours of Saturday that the death toll had risen to 16. Later on Saturday, he said four peo-

ple remain missing after the attack, which wounded a further 130.

Kryvyi Rih is the hometown of Zelenskyy, who described the attack as a double-tap strike, in which an initial wave of drones hit the area followed by a second wave as rescue workers responded.

The Ukrainian leader said the fire, which spread across 9,000 square metres (around 97,000 square feet), had been extinguished and rescue efforts were underway.

Kryvyi Rih has been

KEY POINTS

» Moscow's forces have recently intensified their ballistic missile attacks on Kyiv, exploiting Ukraine's chronic shortage of US-made Patriot air defence interceptors

» Zelenskyy said Saturday Ukrainian forces struck the Novokuibyshevsk oil refinery in Samara, noting it is some 620 miles (1,000 kilometres) from the front line

hit multiple times during the 4½-year all-out war between Russia and Ukraine, with one of the deadliest occurring in April 2025, when 20 people were killed, including nine children.

Large-scale Russian strikes have become a regular occurrence this summer, with Friday's attacks landing just 24 hours after Russia pounded Kyiv with scores of missiles and drones in a nighttime assault that killed 16 people.

Israel did not give warning ahead of recent Syria air strike: US envoy

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Istanbul, August 22

Israel did not warn the United States before it struck an air base in northern Syria this week, despite fears of an escalation with Türkiye, the US special envoy to Syria said.

Tom Barrack, who also serves as ambassador to Türkiye, said the attack on Tuesday on the Abu Duhur base could have been Israel "baiting the Turks ... that was the serious and worrying part."

In the wake of the strikes, which caused damage but no casualties, the office of Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the base was attacked because Syria was "on the verge of breaching" an agreement by allowing Turkish troops to deploy there.

Barrack said it was likely that Israel had intelligence suggesting Türkiye may be bolstering its presence in the area and "a commander somewhere in the field made a decision We're not going to let that happen'...



U.S. Ambassador to Turkey and Special Envoy to Syria Tom Barrack

What they didn't do is tell us or Türkiye."

He added that another possible reason for the attack was miscommunication between the Israel's military and intelligence agency.

Abu Duhur lies around 80 km east of the Turkish border.

"When they (the Turkish military) see these jets coming towards the border and they don't know what the purpose, direction or intention is, they start to say We're going to have to scramble our own," Barrack said as he outlined how close Israel and NATO member Türkiye came to direct

confrontation.

He pointed out that Türkiye had shot down a Russian jet over its Syrian frontier in 2015.

The ambassador's comments were published on X late Friday by Mario Nawfal, a Lebanese-Australian entrepreneur.

Two Syrian officials, who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorised to comment publicly, said on Wednesday that a Turkish delegation had visited the air base in the north-western province of Idlib a day before the air strike to review reconstruction work underway there.

Israel had raised concerns about Turkish military activity at the air base but the US concluded that was "not happening," Barrack said.

"The unintended consequence of a mistake could be really consequential," he added. Türkiye has been supporting Syria's effort to rebuild its armed forces by training Syrian personnel and supplying equipment and logistical support.

Indian national arrested in US over elder fraud

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New York, August 22

An Indian national has been arrested and charged in the US for his alleged role as a "money mule" in a multi-million-dollar scheme targeting elderly victims.

Jay Sunilbharthi Goswami, 21, a Gujarat native who lived in Jersey City, New Jersey, was detained in Canada while attempting to flee to Qatar.

He was charged by criminal complaint with wire fraud, conspiracy to commit wire fraud, money laundering and conspiracy to commit money laundering. The charges carry a maximum penalty of 20 years in prison, US Attorney Michael DiGiacomo said Friday.

Goswami appeared before US Magistrate Judge Mark Pedersen on August 17 and was released under conditions. A day later, he

crossed into Canada. Law enforcement learned he had booked a flight from Toronto to Doha, Qatar, on the evening of August 18.

Canadian authorities detained Goswami at Toronto Pearson International Airport and arrested him on August 20 following a US request for provisional arrest pending extradition.

The perpetrators allegedly told victims that their bank accounts, funds or

personal information had been compromised. They then persuaded them to liquidate assets into cash, gold or gift cards before posing as law enforcement officials or other figures to further the fraud.

Goswami allegedly acted as a money mule, personally collecting or conspiring to collect cash and gold from elderly victims in New York and New Jersey on at least nine occasions.

Pakistan to deploy army for 6 months in Rawalpindi for 'sensitive security duties'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Islamabad, August 22

Pakistan government has approved the deployment of the army for six months in Rawalpindi at the request of Punjab's home department for "sensitive security duties". "The federal government, exercising the powers conferred under Article 245 of the Constitu-

tion of Pakistan, is pleased to authorise the deployment of three companies of the Pakistan Army for sensitive security duties in Rawalpindi," according to a notification issued by the Ministry of Interior and Narcotics Control on Friday.

It said that the decision was taken "to avoid any undesirable situa-

tion as well as to respond effectively in any unforeseen situation as per the requirement of the district administration".

Article 245 of the Constitution pertains to the deployment of armed forces in aid of civil power.

The decision comes days after a man linked to former prime minister Imran Khan's Pakistan Tehreek-

e-Insaf party (PTI) opened fire on security forces and was shot dead in retaliatory firing. PTI distanced itself from the incident, saying it had nothing to do with terrorism and that efforts were being made to link the party to it.

Rawalpindi is the seat of the army, where its head office, called the General Headquarters, is located.

Sport

GILL, JAISWAL IN FOCUS AS INDIA EYE OVERSEAS SERIES WIN IN 3 YRS

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Colombo, August 22

Substantial knocks from skipper Shubman Gill and opener Yashasvi Jaiswal will fill the remaining blank columns as India push for their first overseas Test series victory in three years during the second and final match against Sri Lanka, starting here on Sunday.

India's last Test rubber win abroad was against the West Indies in July 2023.

Since then, India lost to Australia and shared the series with South Africa and England away from home.

In this interim, the defeats at home against New Zealand and South Africa also dimmed the halo around this Indian Test outfit.

But Gill's side regained some ground with a 165-run romp in the first Test at Galle, where Sri Lankan spinners often spun a web around visiting batters.

Despite the inexperience in the Sri Lankan ranks, the result might have come as a relief for the team and head coach Gautam Gambhir after two shattering home defeats against New Zealand and South Africa.

The Galle win has certainly released a pressure valve around the team.

A Test of character



Shubman Gill bats at nets on the eve of the second Test against Sri Lanka

PTI

WTC points table

If India happen to complete a 2-0 clean sweep, they will have a chance to go up to the fourth spot in the World Test Championship (WTC) rankings with 57.58 percentage points.

There is a high possibility that Bangladesh, who are currently fourth in WTC table with 66.67 percentage points post Darwin victory, will lose the second Test against Australia

at McKay and drop down to fifth spot with 55.56 percentage points.

Big innings round the corner?

Amidst the general elation, India will certainly welcome some runs from Gill and Jaiswal.

On the periphery, Gill appears in solid touch, having scored two hundreds in his last six innings.

But scratch the cover, there is a tinge of weak-

ness, a pattern-setting dismissals against spin, particularly the left-arm orthodox variation.

True to that failure, Gill fell twice to Prabath Jayasuriya at Galle, and he will certainly like to set that unwanted record straight, a blemish on an otherwise impeccable run as team leader.

As the skipper, Gill has managed to score 1100 runs in 10 Tests at an aver-

IN SHORT

» As the skipper, Gill has managed to score 1100 runs in 10 Tests at an average of over 73, a remarkable leap from 1893 runs from 32 Tests at 35 before taking over the team's reins

» Jaiswal offers a slightly deeper problem. After scoring a hundred against the West Indies at New Delhi last year, the opener has made just one fifty in his last eight innings

age of over 73, a remarkable leap from 1893 runs from 32 Tests at 35 before taking over the team's reins.

Kuldeep Yadav is the third member of the eleven that struggled to make an impact at Galle. He had a disappointing outing, taking a solitary wicket from 25 overs across two innings despite the pitch offering considerable assistance.

Kuldeep was also the most expensive among the bowlers, leaking over four runs an over in the opening Test.

Gayatri-Treesa's jolly good run ends with bronze medal

Clinch maiden World Championships bronze

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Amstelveen, August 22

Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand's extraordinary run ended with a fighting three-game loss to world No. 1 and defending champions Liu Sheng Shu and Tan Ning in the women's doubles semifinals at the World Championships here on Saturday as the Indian pair signed off with a maiden bronze medal.

The unseeded Indians produced a sensational start to pocket the opening game but could not sustain the pressure against the mighty Chinese pair, going down 21-18, 13-21, 8-21 in an hour and 11 minutes. India last won a BWF World Championships medal in women's doubles in 2011, when Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa claimed bronze in London. Reflecting on their match, Gayatri said they lacked patience and also didn't have the rhythm in the second game.

"In the second set, they played very patiently and we couldn't match both. It happens. Treesa played really well from the back court. If I had supported



Treesa Jolly during the semi-final clash

PTI

THIS IS INDIA'S FIRST WOMEN'S DOUBLES MEDAL AT THE BWF WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS SINCE 2011

a little more from the net, we could have pulled off the second set," she said.

"Also in the third set, there were a few points which we could have converted, but the rhythm didn't come."

Ranked 39th in the world, the Indian pair had defeated three seeded pairs to reach the semifinals.

"After the second game, second half, I feel like the

few mistakes that made us a little bit kind of doubtful about the strokes, what we are playing. Then we went for more defensive and we cannot play against them defensively," Treesa said.

The Indian pair didn't have a favourable head-to-head record against the Chinese, having lost six times with just one to show in seven meetings so far.

A crowd of close to 8,000 had turned up to cheer the Indian pair as they raced to a 7-2 lead to put the Chinese pair under early pressure.

Liu and Tan, however, quickly fought their way back with six straight points to move ahead.

Neeraj's season-best throw not enough, ends 2nd

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Lausanne, August 22

Indian javelin ace Neeraj Chopra produced his best performance in more than a year but was pipped to the post by the rising Sri Lankan star Rumesh Pathirage for the top spot by a



mere nine centimetres in the Lausanne Diamond League meet here on Friday. The 28-year-old Chopra's 88.05m throw in the second round, which fetched him the second spot in the nine-man star-studded field, was his best after the 88.16m he

recorded while winning the Paris Diamond League in June 2025. It was also his season's best throw.

However, the 23-year-old Pathirage continued his juggernaut this season as he overtook Chopra with his third-round throw of 88.14m.



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 05/2026-27 dt. : 20.08.2026

On behalf of the President of India, Senior Divisional Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Jhansi, invites the E-procurement tender for following item :-

SN	Tender No.	Qty.	Tender Opening date
1	92266956	612838 Nos.	14.09.2026

Brief Description : Supply of ELASTIC RAIL CLIP(ERC) MK-V WITH FLAT TOE FOR 60KG UIC/52KG RAIL SECTIONS DRG. (RDSO_T_5919_Alt_2 SPEC. (RDSO) IRS/T-31-2025 Sixth Revision

Note :- ➤ The complete information of above E-Procurement is available on IREPS website i.e <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. Please visit this website regularly for any changes/corrigendum in the tender. No separate corrigendum will be published in the newspaper. **1927/25 (D)**

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @ CPNCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Gaurav Kumar S/o Om Prakash, R/o H. No. F-102, Jatav Mohalla, Tughlakabad Village, New Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 378/2021 U/s 33 DEA PS: New Friends Colony, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gaurav Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gaurav Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Gaurav Kumar** accused of **FIR No. 378/2021 U/s 33 DEA PS: New Friends Colony, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vinod Joshi
ACJM, Room No. 515
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/11813/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Subash Chandra Yadav R/o Anand NVI Project Pvt. Ltd. Plot No. 33, Sector-35, Khatola, Near Shani Mandir, Gurgaon-12200 Haryana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 4422/2023, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Moti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Subash Chandra Yadav** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Subash Chandra Yadav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Subash Chandra Yadav** of Case **FIR No. 4422/2023, U/s 138 NI Act, PS Moti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **23.09.2026**.

By Order
Judge
Evening Court No. 02, Room No. 151
2nd Floor, Tis Hazari Court, New Delhi

DP/10983/WD/2026
(Court Matter)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. : SIG-WS-CONTRACT-584 **Dated : 19.08.2026**

E-Tender Notice

E-Tender Notice No. SIG-WS-CONTRACT-584 Dated :- 19.08.2026 Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/Construction/North Central Railway/Prayagraj GM Office, Betwa Building, Subedarganj, Prayagraj for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tenders on the prescribed form upto 15:00 Hrs. on 14.09.2026 for the under noted work, which will be opened on the same day at 15:30 Hrs.

Tender No. : SIG-WS-CONTRACT-584 **Completion of period : 12 Months**

Name of work : Infringement removal/Utility shifting of Signalling & Telecom cables and equipment's in connection with Double line work in CAR-CPU section in Prayagraj division of North Central Railway.

Approx Cost of work (Rs.) : Rs. 2,79,34,116.38 (Two crore Seventy Nine Lakh Thirty Four Thousand One Hundred Sixteen and Thirty Eight paise only).

Earnest Money (Rs.) : Rs. 5,58,700/- (Five Lakh Fifty Eight Thousand Seven Hundred only).

Date & time of Closing/Opening of Tender : Up to 14.09.2026 15:00 Hrs. and will be opened at 15:30 Hrs. on the same day.

Web site particular and Notice Board location where complete details of tender can be seen : Web site www.ireps.gov.in Notice Board provided in the office of the Dy Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/Construction/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, GM office, Betwa Building, Subedarganj, Prayagraj. **1926/26 (C)**

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @ CPNCR



UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025886 Website: www.ujvn.com

RO.No. 712 **E-Tender Notice** **Dated: 21.08.2026**

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites online bid from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No: 23/EE(Civil)/MB-II/Chinyalisaur/2026-27

Name of work: Strengthening of strata and ground improvement works including channelization of leakage water flowing out from HRT of MB-II HEP at Gamri Gad, Distt-Uttarkashi.

Estimated cost:- Rs. 8,15,24,668.00(excluding GST)

Date of availability of bid document on website : 22.08.2026 from 5:00 PM

Last Date for submission of Tender on website : 15.09.2026 upto 05:00 PM

For fuller & further details, kindly visit "e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>"

Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur.

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Satyawan @ Sonu, S/o: Rajbir Khatak, R/o: H.No. 276, Phase-II, Gali No. 2, Chanchal Park, Nangloi, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 157/2013, U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Satyawan @ Sonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Satyawan @ Sonu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Satyawan @ Sonu** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 157/2013, U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Shashank Nandan Bhatt
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 (West)
Room No. 356, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11767/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, रौंजी

ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट सूचना
टेंडर रेफरेंस नं०-५०नि०वि०/रौंजी-18/2026-27
दिनांक :-21.08.2026

	कार्य का नाम	
1.	अनुमानित प्राक्कलित राशि (रु० लाख में)	Surface Renewal of Road from Ratu Road Junction (New Market) to HEC Gate (Birsra Rajpath) (MDR-015) (Total Length 7.80 KM) for the year 2026-27.
2.	अनुमानित प्राक्कलित राशि (रु० लाख में)	रु० 464.29205 लाख (रुपये चार करोड़ चौसठ लाख उनतीस हजार दो सौ पांच) मात्र।
3.	अग्रघन की राशि (रु० लाख में)	रु० 4.65 लाख (रुपये चार लाख पैसठ हजार) मात्र।
4.	समय	03 (तीन) माह
5.	वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	25.08.2026
6.	निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि/ समय	10.30 बजे पूर्वाह्न
7.	निविदा खोलने की तिथि/ समय	16.09.2026
8.	निविदा प्रकाशित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता	12.00 बजे दोपहर तक
9.	प्रोक्योरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क संख्या	18.09.2026
10.	ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट सूच का हेल्पलाईन संख्या	12.30 बजे अपराह्न।
		कार्यालयक अभियंता पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, मोहराबादी, रौंजी-834008.
		0651-2361018
		0651-2403007

- प्राक्कलित राशि एवं अग्रघन की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है, जिसे **Tender Online Upload** में देखा जा सकता है, एवं किसी भी प्रकार का बदलाव <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।
- नियम एवं शर्तों के लिए वेबसाइट <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> पर देखें।

PR 388204 Road Construction कार्यपालक अभियंता
Dept Road Division Ranchi(26-27).D पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, रौंजी



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 26/39 **Dated: 21.08.2026**

E-Procurement Tender Notice

On behalf of the President of India, The Principal Chief Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj (An ISO 9001:2015 certified unit) invites the following E-Procurement tenders:

S. No.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Tender Opening Date
1	38262327	Torsion Spring (Steel) for Automatic Twist Lock	12889 Nos.	21.09.2026
2	30261751	Non Asbestos Based "K" Type High Friction Composite Brake Blocks	138190 Nos.	22.09.2026
3	30262048A	SECONDARY VERTICAL DAMPER FOR LHB AC COACHES	970 Nos.	22.10.2026
4	30262300	SPEED SENSOR	376 Nos.	08.09.2026
5	10263110A	Long Life Loco Side Buffer Assembly	360 Nos.	15.09.2026
6	20263470A	NI-CD Battery	207 Nos.	21.09.2026
7	38261896	POH Kit for KE2 Type Distributor Valve	2878 Nos.	15.09.2026
8	30262231	Rear Cover for Axle Box	7772 Nos.	29.09.2026
9	38263232	Cast Steel Side Frame	473 Nos.	07.10.2026

Note: The complete information of above tenders can be seen and downloaded from IREPS website i.e. <https://www.ireps.gov.in>. For any change/corrigendum in tender, please visit this website regularly. No separate corrigendum/change will be published in news paper. **1939/26 (MG)**

 North central railways  @CPNCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ankit Kumar @ Chanda S/o Lal Mani Pandey R/o H-552, JJ Colony, Shakurpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **E-FIR No. 321/18, U/S 379/411 IPC, PS Subhash Place, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Ankit Kumar @ Chanda** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ankit Kumar @ Chanda** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ankit Kumar @ Chanda** of **E-FIR No. 321/18, U/S 379/411 IPC, PS Subhash Place, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **23.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Upasana Satija
Chief Judicial Magistrate
Room No.108, North West, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11743/NW/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nitin, S/o Bhagwan Das, R/o H.No. 814, Pocket-4, Sector-A6, Narela, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 240/2024, U/s 326/34 IPC & 25/27/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Nitin** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Nitin** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Nitin** accused of **FIR No. 240/2024, U/s 326/34 IPC & 25/27/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.09.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Preeti Rajoria
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, Central
Room No. 32, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11773/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2)(ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Naveen Rana S/o Ajit Rana, R/o: H. NO. 345/9, Natan Pana Village Mangerpur also at Municipal Corporation Primary School, 1-Block, Shakarpur, Delhi** (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **CC No. 2192/21, U/s 138 NI ACT**, registered at P.S.: Rani Bagh, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Naveen Rana** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Naveen Rana** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Naveen Rana** accused **CC No. 2192/21, U/s 138 NI ACT**, registered at P.S.: Rani Bagh, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.10.2026**.

By Order
Aakansha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North West, Court No. 107, First Floor
Rohini Courts Complex, Delhi

DP/11776/OD/2026
(Court Matter)



CHANGE OF NAME

I, Satish Kumar S/o Ramkaran, R/o R.C.-961, Indira Vihar, Near Birbal School Gali No.-07, B Block, Khoda Colony Gaziabad. That my daughter Aadhar Card and Birth Certificate her name mention Nandita and in school record my daughter name mentioned Nandita Goutam. That My daughter correct name is Nandita for all future purposes.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Amit S/o Lt. Dilal Singh, R/o: H.No. B-8, Vishwash Park, Uttam Nagar, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 121/2025, U/S 331(3)/305/317(2) IPC, PS Nihal Vihar, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amit** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Amit** the said accused of **FIR No. 121/2025, U/S 331(3)/305/317(2) IPC, PS Nihal Vihar, Outer Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Komal Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
West Distt., Room No.-292,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11803/OD/2026
(Court Matter)



UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O. "UJJWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN-248006
Tele: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvn.com

Tender No.718 **Date : 22.08.2026**

TENDER NOTICE

Office of the Executive Engineer (Maintenance), Vyasi Project, Hathiyari, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
NIT No. 14 & 15/EE(M)/VP/2026-27
Name of work:- 1- Providing and fixing of Oil Storeroom in Vyasi Power House, Hathiyari...
2- Fabrication of stairs for draft tube gate, TRC gates and surge shaft gate hoist at Vyasi Powerhouse Hathiyari
Estimated cost:- ₹ 9,98,897/- (Excluding GST) & ₹ 8,74,700/- (Excluding GST)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 23-08-2026 From 16:00 AM
Last date for submission of tender: 15-09-2026 Up-to 13:30 PM
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvn.com"
Executive Engineer (Maintenance) Vyasi Project, Hathiyari

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.: CNB2026202702 **E-TENDER NOTICE** **Date: 19.08.2026**

Dy. Chief Engineer/Construction, North Central Railway, Opposite Jhakarkati Bus Stand, G.T. Road, Kanpur-208001, acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-tenders for the following works with closing date/time as mentioned below. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.

S. N. : 01 **Tender No.:** CNB2026202702

Brief Description of work : Provision of FOB 3m wide with ramps & other allied works at Sirhi Itara, Kathara, Patara, Dohru and Dapsaura stations on Bhimsen Yamuna South Bank Section in C/with Doubling work between Khairar-Bhimsen station of North Central Railway.

Approximate cost: Rs. 25.29 Crore	Amount of EMD: Rs.50,57,200/-
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Cost of Tender Document: Nil **Tender closing date:** 21.09.2026 at 15:00 hours

Completion period: 06 months. **Note :-** 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-works tender will be available on website on <https://ireps.gov.in> up to 15:00 hrs on the due date of tender opening. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose venders are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with class III Digital signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. Rate entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by tenderer shall be straight way ignored and shall not be considered. 4. Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 5. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **1935/26 (D)**

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPNCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Stello Max Pvt Ltd. Ahed Khan S/o Ismail Khan R/o H. No. 102, Tower No.5, Ground Fort, Society-76, SIGMS 4, Greater Noida, Distt. Gautam Budhnagar, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **CT Case 839/19 U/S 452/506/34323/341 IPC Act, PS Mayur Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Stello Max Pvt Ltd. Ahed Khan** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Stello Max Pvt Ltd. Ahed Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Stello Max Pvt Ltd. Ahed Khan** of **CT Case 839/19 U/S 452/506/34323/341 IPC Act, PS Mayur Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **13.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Ritika Kansal
Judicial Magistrate First Class (Mahila Court-02)
Court No.24
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/11663/ED/2026(Court Matter)

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD(R&B) DIVISION VIJAYPUR

ABBREVIATED NOTICE INVITING TENDER

e-NIT No. 48 of 2026-27 Dated. 21-08-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works

S. No	Name of Work	Estimated cost of Work (in Lacs)	Cost of Tender Doc. (in Rs.)	Earnest Money(In Rs.)	Time allowed for completion	Class of Contractor
1	Const. of lanes and drains in Ward No. 1 to 13 Vijaypur.	192.35	3000	2% of Adv. Cost	06 Months (incl. all rainy days)	"A"
2	Const. of Double Storey Examination Hall with 02 No. of ACR's at HSS Vijaypur.	121.53	3000	2% of Adv. Cost	12 Months (incl. all rainy days)	"A"

Position of AAA :- Accorded
Position of T.S :- Sanctioned
Project Authority :- S.No. 01 under Capex Budget 2026-27 (New works) and S.No. 02 under Capex Budget 2025-26 (UT Sector).

	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	
1	Period of downloading of bidding documents	21-08-2026 From 21-08-2026 to 11-09-2026
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	24-08-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur
4	Bid submission Start Date	21-08-2026 at 1800 Hrs
5	Bid Submission End Date	11-09-2026 upto 1600 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	12-09-2026 on or after 1400 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

The tender is available at website <http://jktenders.gov.in> all other terms & conditions can be seen on the above website

Sd/- Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division Vijaypur

DIP No:DIP/J-8643/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **S Dimpuna S/o S Rengkharang R/o H. No. 128/9 Kilokari, New Delhi** Also At **New Canaan Village, Loktak Project, Manipur** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 176/2025, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Sunlight Colony, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **S Dimpuna** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **S Dimpuna** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **S Dimpuna** of case **FIR No. 176/2025, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Sunlight Colony, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **16.10.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order
Divyam Lila
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
South-East Distt., Room No. 508
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/11630/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shiv Kumar S/o Tilak Singh R/o H. No. G-7, Lal Kuan, Badarpur, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 328/2018 U/S 33/52 Delhi Excise Act, PS Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Shiv Kumar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Shiv Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shiv Kumar** of **FIR No.328/2018 U/S 33/52 Delhi Excise Act, PS Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **24.09.2026 at 10:00 am**.

By Order,
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-3
South East
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/11855/SE/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sahil, S/o Shankar R/o House No.416, 2nd Floor, Near Ramleela Ground, Mukesh Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.147/2026 dated 03.06.2026 u/s 21/25/29 NDPS Act, P.S. Crime Branch, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sahil** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sahil** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sahil** of **FIR No.147/2026 dated 03.06.2026 u/s 21/25/29 NDPS Act, P.S. Crime Branch, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Kuldeep Narayan
Judicial Magistrate (NDPS) Central District
Room No.222, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

Additional Sessions Judge, Special Judge (NDPS) Central District
DP/11850/Crime/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Vinod, S/o Kishan Lal R/o 26/83, First Floor, Trilokpuri, Mayur Vihar Phase-1, East Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence Case **CT Case No. 518/21 u/s 452/506/34323/341 IPC at P.S. Mayur Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Vinod** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Vinod** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vinod** accused of **CT Case No. 518/21 u/s 452/506/34323/341 IPC at P.S. Mayur Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.10.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Ritika Kansal,
Judicial Megistrate First Class (Mahila Court)-02,
Court No.- 24,
Karkardooma Court, Delhi.

DP/11666/ED/2026

India's Empty Bottles



The flood waters ravaging many parts of India have left behind a scattered and telling reminder of a much larger Indian failing. We are remarkably generous at giving, and almost as remarkably irresponsible with the waste we leave behind

MPOST BUREAU

The floods came rushing into Assam, Bihar, Uttarakhand and other parts of India. People needed emergency survival supplies and relief, especially water. Bottled water poured in by the truckloads, as it should. The Government, relief agencies, volunteers, companies and ordinary citizens did what Indians do wonderfully well in a crisis: they opened their hearts and gave. Now to the less photogenic part. What happens to all those empty bottles? It is a question that is almost absurd to ask in the middle of a humanitarian crisis. Yet, it is precisely the question India postpones until the cameras have gone away. Yes, the water was necessary. The bottle was unavoidable. But the bottle does not magically disappear simply because the emergency does.

This is where the earlier column on this year's devastating floods opens an uncomfortable doorway into all of India. Because the floodwaters will recede. The empty plastic bottles will remain.

Not My Problem

Look around India and the evidence is everywhere. The plastic bottle thrown beside the highway. The wafer packet dropped five feet from a dustbin. The namkeen wrapper pushed under a park bench. The cigarette packet crushed onto a pavement. The empty soft-drink bottle rolling along a railway platform. The takeaway container abandoned outside a restaurant. The beer bottle left behind on a mountain. Because carrying a full bottle uphill is admirable, but carrying an empty one back down the same hill is unbearable.

We consume. We discard. We walk away. Somebody else will clean it. That somebody is usually a municipal worker, a sanitation worker, a waste picker or an invisible army of people whose labour we notice only when they fail to perform it. This is not merely a garbage problem. It is a civic character disaster.

India generated an estimated 4.14 million tonnes of plastic waste in 2022-23, according to data submitted by the Government in Parliament. The country generated an average 1.70 lakh tonnes of municipal solid waste every day, of which about 91,500 tonnes was treated, according to the latest available estimates.

Same Story, Different Cities

Urban flooding in India is not caused by heavy rain alone. In cities such as Delhi, Gurugram, Mumbai and Bengaluru, intense rainfall increasingly exposes another problem: drains and natural waterways that cannot carry stormwater because they are clogged with garbage. Plastic bottles, food packaging, polythene bags, disposable cups and other litter routinely find their way into roadside drains. When heavy rain arrives, this waste restricts water flow, while poorly maintained or inadequate drainage systems compound the problem. Water then backs up onto roads, enters residential areas and brings traffic to a standstill.

The problem points to failures on both sides. Municipal authorities must ensure regular waste collection, drain desilting and enforcement against illegal dumping. But civic behaviour matters equally. A plastic bottle casually thrown on a road may eventually be swept into a stormwater drain and



contribute to a blockage during the next downpour. Rapid construction has further reduced the ability of cities to absorb rainwater as open land, wetlands and other permeable surfaces disappear beneath concrete. Urban India, therefore, cannot treat flooding simply as a monsoon problem. Better drainage infrastructure is essential, but so are responsible waste disposal and civic discipline. Keeping drains free of garbage may be among the simplest—and most neglected—forms of flood prevention.

The numbers are enormous. But walk down an ordinary Indian street and the problem becomes much simpler. It is one empty bottle. Then another. And another.

Clean-Up Delusion

We have spent years talking about cleanliness as though it were primarily a government service or responsibility. Of course, municipalities have responsibilities. Collection, segregation, recycling, processing and disposal require infrastructure. India has laws governing plastic waste. Producers have

'Extended Producer Responsibility' obligations. Urban local bodies and gram panchayats have responsibilities for collection and management. Identified single-use plastic items have been banned since 2022.

But legislation cannot compensate indefinitely for the absence of civic behaviour. A municipal worker can collect the garbage. He cannot stop a citizen from throwing it. The authorities can install a dustbin. They cannot force someone to walk three metres towards it. A manufacturer can be made responsible for its packaging. It cannot follow every bottle after an Indian consumer has flung it into a drain.

We have somehow constructed a remarkable social arrangement in which the person who creates the waste has the least responsibility for it. And this instinct extends far beyond garbage. Someone else will clean the street. Someone else will unclog the drain. Someone else will pick up the cigarette packet. Someone else will remove the plastic from the river. Someone else will repair what we break. Someone else. Always someone else.

What Belongs to Us

Perhaps the real problem is that we have never quite understood the idea of 'The Commons'. The road is ours. The pavement is ours. The river is ours. The mountain is ours. The railway station, the park, the beach, the public

toilet – all of them are ours. Not the Government's. Not the municipality's. Ours.

And yet, anything that belongs to everybody somehow becomes nobody's responsibility. We will protect the cleanliness of our home because it is ours. We will wash our car because it is ours. We will complain furiously if somebody litters outside our gate. But move ten metres beyond that imaginary boundary and the moral obligation often disappears.

That is not a failure of sanitation. It is a failure of citizenship. A country does not become developed because it builds airports, expressways, metros and smart cities. Development is also the ability of citizens to understand that the space between their front door and the horizon belongs to them too. We cannot build world-class cities while behaving as though everything outside our doors belongs to somebody else. The empty bottle is more than an empty bottle. It is an embarrassing measure of how developed we really are.

You Know Better

The uncomfortable evidence that this is not an inability but a choice comes from Indians who live abroad. Many who might casually litter at home learn very quickly to queue, respect public spaces, follow civic rules and dispose of waste responsibly elsewhere. The DNA did not change at the airport. The social

contract did. And that is perhaps the most damning evidence.

We know how to behave. We simply behave differently when we believe nobody will hold us to account. Occasionally, even the habit travels. Public spaces abroad are sometimes treated as extensions of the drawing room, celebrations spill into places never intended for them, and the assumption that enthusiasm excuses inconvenience can travel surprisingly well.

But the larger point remains. Civic sense is not something Indians lack. It is something we selectively practise.

Enough Is Enough

There is nothing wrong with being generous. Quite the opposite. The outpouring of relief for Assam and other flood-ravaged parts of India is something to be proud of. But perhaps we have confused charity with citizenship. Charity is dramatic. It is visible. It feels good. It allows us to see ourselves as compassionate human beings. Citizenship is quieter. It is doing the right thing when nobody is watching, nobody is photographing it and nobody is going to thank you.

It is understanding that the road outside your house is not somebody else's road. That the river is not somebody else's river. That the mountain is not somebody else's mountain. That the garbage you throw away does not cease to be your responsibility merely because it has left your hand.

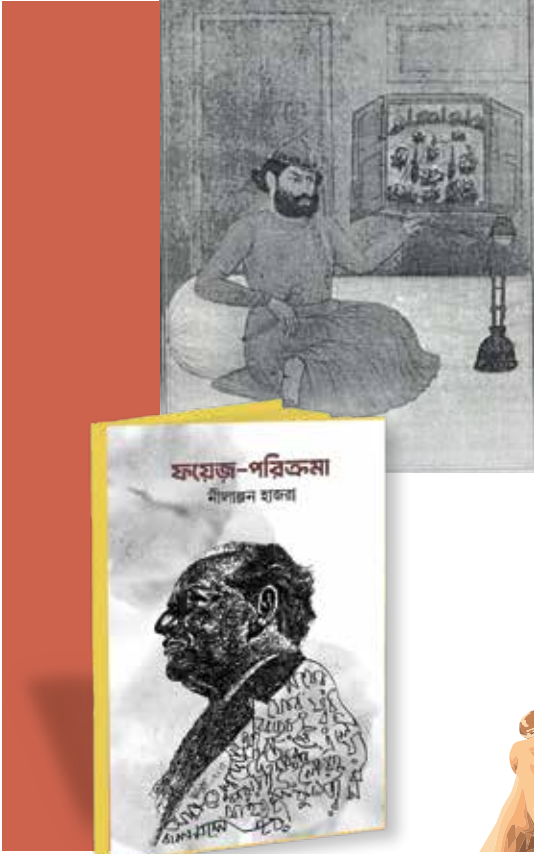
You want to be a developed country? Start with your empty bottle. For development is not only airports, expressways, metros, satellites and GDP. It is the discipline to live responsibly among other people. The water sent to flood victims was an act of compassion. What happens to the empty bottle is an act of citizenship. The floods will eventually recede. The water will be consumed. The cameras will move on. The bottles will remain. As will the habits that produced them.

Perhaps it is time we stopped asking who will clean up after India. And started asking why India keeps expecting somebody else to.



EMPTY BOTTLES ARE NOT THE PROBLEM. THE PROBLEM IS THE INDIAN BELIEF THAT ONCE SOMETHING BECOMES WASTE, IT BECOMES SOMEBODY ELSE'S RESPONSIBILITY

Epistle as Eulogy to Evergreen Faiz



Edward Said regarded him as the best Urdu poet of the last century. But he was much more. Faiz Ahmed Faiz was a Marxist and dedicated activist who always uttered the unpalatable truth. Nilanjan Hazra, in his excellent recently published book on him, **Faiz-Parikrama/Faiz-Peregrination**, has linked him with his hallowed predecessors and placed him in our present tormented moment

AUTHOR



SUBHORANJAN DASGUPTA

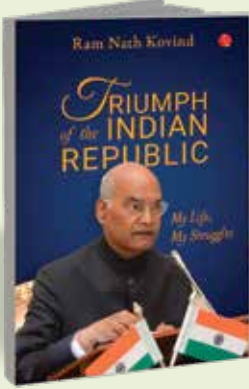
Nilanjan,
Before reading this splendid book written by you, I had read Romila Thapar's unforgettable *Just Being* (A Memoir). I know that you are feeling slightly uneasy because, perhaps, you did not expect me to couple your name with that undisputed Empress of Indian history-writing. You might even protest and say, "Why this inexplicable comparison?"
But there are reasons, not one but three, which have prompted me to pronounce your name with Romila's in one, indivisible breath. One, I have read both these books without permitting a pause, because both were so irresistible. Two, both of you have spread your canvases far and wide and included so many themes, from childhood memory to the articulation of your commitment at this moment of sociopolitical sacrilege. And third - this is perhaps most crucial - you two have reached your defiant terrain by recalling and relying on the creativity of Faiz Ahmed Faiz, laced as it is with rock-hard protest and sublime love.
Indeed, Romila pronounced Faiz's resolution as well as hers even before beginning the first chapter. The resolve of the historian and the poet found a common expression in the following lines of the poem *Bol/Speak*:
Speak, for even this brief moment is ample
Prior to the dying of body and tongue.
Speak, that truth still lives
Speak, to say whatever is to be said.
But, Nilanjan, you have not confined yourself within the ambit of Faiz's verse. You have drawn sustenance from its fervour and then, like Romila, you have spread your wings and traversed the sky. That is why I place this compelling query to you, recollecting the idiom of my illustrious cousin and poet, Alokranjan Dasgupta: is Faiz your 'heavenly excuse' or 'irrepressible vow', or perhaps, both inextricably intertwined?
What has surprised me first is your stiletto-sharp comments on our desecrated reality. That is, the microcosm of protest in Faiz's verse has led to the depiction of our actuality, macrocosmic,

in its shocking expanse. I shall just quote three screenshots which reflect our diurnal condition.
One: "We know very well that in Pakistan and in other countries, Islam, like five other religions, has been abused and desecrated in a manner that has absolutely nothing to do with Islam." (Page 117)
Two: "There is a fundamental difference between Fascist autocracy and other autocracies. The difference is, Fascism comes to stop power by winning the heart, by securing massive people's support ... and its terrible danger lies precisely here. The Fascist leader always incites a collective madness which you might describe as 'mass hysteria'. The latter constitutes the real basis of its power and strength" (Page 125)
Three: "At least in India, the Communists have only invested in politics and that politics which is geared only to the capture of power. In comparison, they have not invested even a fraction in the socio-human sphere. They have left the social terrain of their countrymen totally open and unprotected." (Pages 124-125).
These three observations are so outrageously honest that you do not need to dissect them. I have immense faith in my readers; they will realise why the author has pronounced these verdicts. But then comes the crucial question. If this is our scandalous actuality or *Seiendes* - to use the very appropriate German expression - wherein lies the counter-world, counter-reality and *Nicht-seiendes*? The author has answered this question. This counter-world has been created, is being created, will be created by creativity itself and the defiant aesthetic that sustains it. The acclaimed German dramatist, Peter Weiss, has defined it as the indispensable *Aesthetic of Resistance*, and it is this that ignites the poems of Faiz.
The author has not restricted his exploration within the poetic parameters of Faiz. He has used him, in the way Dante used Virgil, and traced the majestic tradition of Urdu poetry - from Ghalib to Meer, from Meer to Wali, from Wali to Faiz himself and further on to Kaifi Azmi. With what immaculate exactitude has he painted this entire canvas - memorable words encasing the social heartbeat. Here too, I shall discard the cloak of the pedantic professor and go directly to the verse itself, which says all like uninhibited prayers. Consider, for example, the following lines of Meer, written in 1782, more than two centuries ago (!), which address our own violated moment with striking immediacy:
What would you like to know more about Meer's faith and religion,
He has drawn tilak on his forehead in the temple

And discarded Islam so many years ago.
It is impossible to decipher the route of this poetic heritage; it is so complex and subtle. Nevertheless, Meer leads us to Safiuddin, Kaifi Azmi and, above all, to Faiz, whom no less a reader than Edward Said described as the most eloquent voice in Urdu poetry. But before we come to him, let me recall the deathless defiance of Safiuddin:
Where have men fought
Where have men failed
Where have they been killed,
All these are human hymns
Which emerge and stand erect
(Night)
FROM
GHALIB AND
MEER TO FAIZ AND KAIFI
AZMI, A LITERARY JOURNEY
DISCOVERS POETRY'S
ENDURING POWER TO
RESIST HATRED AND
OPPRESSION
This same emotional disposition urged the sorrow-struck Kaifi Azmi to look for the 'merciful and compassionate' Ram in Ayodhya. He was not there when violence erupted; hence Azmi questioned: "To which deity are you offering prayers? Ram has left Ayodhya in grief." Faiz represents the crest of this flow and the author has translated his poems, one after another, into chaste and vibrant Bengali. The latter compete with the masterly translations in English done by renowned poets like Victor Kiernan, Agha Shahid Ali and, finally, Baran Farooqi.
As with Pablo Neruda and Paul Eluard, the two polestars in Faiz's firmament are love and resistance, and both have received resplendent expressions. The poem January 1958 resounds with the following words:
Intense commotion will no longer echo
In this silence burdened with sorrow
That commotion which demands inborn rights
Will not the slogan of battle ring again?
Such proclamations give way to the most tender utterance of romantic love and to hymns celebrating feminine beauty:
Colour: the name of your dress
Perfume: the name of your hair flowing in the wind

The season of the flowers is the name of
Your appearance on the balcony.
(Ghazal translated by Baran Farooqi)
I confess that I clasp Faiz with the help of Nilanjan and then I reach that ineffable world of love and defiance peopled by Heinrich Heine, Paul Eluard, Louis Aragon, Pablo Neruda, Bertolt Brecht, Nazrul Islam, Bishnu Dey - what an incomparable pantheon! Is this the discovery that awaits the 'heavenly excuse' about which I spoke at the very start?
This book is irreplaceable for another reason. Quite a few provoked the disruptive thought that Faiz, wedded to equality and enemy of authoritarianism, did not salute the Liberation War of Bangladesh. He was indifferent to it, they complained. The author has engaged in assiduous research and found throbbing evidence of his support in five tormented poems written in that dark year, 1971. Poems, and nothing else, reveal the poet at his truest, and Faiz has written in the fourth poem:
Look at that body, changed into killing field
What more has the viewer to see in the heart's scaffold?
Again, in the third poem, which is simply an example of laceration:
I wash these morbid eyes with blood
I wash these two morbid eyes with blood
Now, every face
Every object in this world
Turn scarlet-red coloured by the blood
Of my two eyes.
The more I read these poems of searing agony, the more I realise that Faiz, with many other aroused Pakistanis, supported the war of liberation unflinchingly.
I, nevertheless, am particularly drawn to one tragic lyric which exhales our scarred history. This poet-humanist could not accept the Partition of 1947 like Ritwik Ghatak, Manik Bandyopadhyay, Akhtaruzzaman Elias and Kayes Ahmed. Wringing his heart out, he lamented on August 15, 1947:
This stained pitted first night
This daybreak battered by night
This dawn that we ached for
This is not that one
Agha Shahid Ali's translation is impeccable. Nilanjan, why don't you translate this poem into Bengali and include it in the next edition? Faiz reached the very pinnacle of our fragmented agony in this lament. I return to it again and again.
You have written a wonderful book, in gratitude and in love.

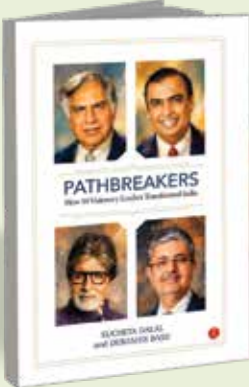
Fresh on the shelf



TRIUMPH OF THE INDIAN REPUBLIC

Ram Nath Kovind

Triumph of the Indian Republic: My Life, My Struggles chronicles Ram Nath Kovind's journey from Paraunkh village to Rashtrapati Bhavan. With candour and insight, the former President reflects on politics, diplomacy, Covid-19, constitutional challenges and presidential power, offering a rare glimpse into his life and India's highest constitutional office.



PATHBREAKERS

Sucheta Dalal and Debashis Basu

Pathbreakers brings together intimate conversations with ten of India's most influential institution-builders, including Mukesh Ambani, Ratan Tata, Uday Kotak and Rajkumar Hirani. Updated for 2026, Sucheta Dalal and Debashis Basu explore leadership, resilience, ambition and setbacks, revealing the choices and convictions behind some of modern India's remarkable success stories.



SWAN SONG

Charles Spencer

Swan Song: Diana, My Sister is Charles Spencer's intimate account of Princess Diana's life, told through a brother's memories. Nearly thirty years after her death, Spencer reflects candidly on their relationship, her remarkable personality and her final days, challenging enduring misconceptions while offering a deeply personal portrait of an enduring icon.



1873

Liaquat Ahamed

1873 by Liaquat Ahamed chronicles the world's first global financial crash and its far-reaching consequences. From Vienna to Wall Street, Ahamed explores how speculation and easy capital triggered economic turmoil, reshaped politics and trade, and fuelled social unrest, revealing how financial crises can transform societies for generations.

The Circle of Care

As parents grow older, the hands that once held ours increasingly need our presence, patience, reassurance and care

AUTHOR



MITALI MADHUSMITA

The call from an unknown number came at 2:15 am as the world was asleep. It was the helper; my mother was adamant about getting up & walking. The doctors & nurses at the High Dependency Unit of the hospital had given clear instructions that she had to be on bed rest while blood thinners were being injected to treat her Deep Vein Thrombosis. As I spoke to her, my heart plummeted to hear her agitation, each yell leading to a dip in oxygen in her chronically deprived lungs. Strangely, it also felt exhilarating that this 86-year-old had the will to regain her normal life, restricted as it already was. Benjamin Franklin famously said, ‘In this world, nothing can be said to be certain, except death & taxes’. We humans are wired to survive. We know how to live but cannot contemplate ageing and death. Invariably, it is with a sense of shock that we grapple with the



fact that something is not all right with our parents or that age is catching up with them. A quivering voice, panic in the eyes as you leave them, and a fading memory leading to repeated questions are the first giveaways. Suddenly, you observe closely the stooping posture, the quivering fingers, the struggle for words, names and places. Once upon a time, they held our hands, wiped our noses and our mess, and saw us off on our journey as work & marriage took us elsewhere from home. I have never faced a situation when my fiercely independent parents held me back or demanded that I visit more often. I, like all parents, have seen off my own children to their

colleges or workplaces with a sinking sense of melancholy. We constantly struggle to be the banyan trees they were, rooted in values and shading weary travellers, including their own, journeying along their path. It is only when we become parents that we realise that there is no mantra for good parenting (despite what the learned books say) and that they, too, made mistakes. Our parents were a hardy generation, born pre-Independence, with all the attendant struggles of shortages (including financial ones) and hardships.

As you progress through life, you recall with a sense of mortification the inconveniences parents bore without fuss while raising kids, and their stoicism in the face of the selfishness you subjected them to, the occasions when you deliberately defied them and the number of times you stumbled. Our own



children’s capriciousness as they grow up reminds us of the delicate tightrope they must have walked. It makes me ponder how roles have flipped; I threw tantrums if, God forbid, my homemaker mother was missing when I returned home from school, when, as a working mother, my children never had me around when they returned from school. I was the one clinging on to her, refusing to stay over the holidays with Granny. God knows she deserved her rest with the unenviable job of looking after 4 kids, her in-laws and other assorted family members! Yet, we were patiently admonished for our mistakes, never punished. For us, their silence at our juvenile

antics was worse than eloquence! It is, therefore, with the greatest sense of awe and humility that we accept that our roles have reversed as we age. Our parents, whose very words were sacrosanct for decades, must now be counselled, their hands patted and hugs given. It is you who ‘mothers’ them, you who plays the part of ‘big daddy’. Deep inside, they understand you have a family and a life to be lived; all they long for is a sliver of your time. It is not material things they crave; those are there in plenty. It is just the attention and company of loved ones that they seek.

I have sensed frustration in the rebuke when I apologetically offer details of my next visit, questioning the necessity of informing them of my plans when they were fine alone most of the time. Initially, I was caught by surprise at this outburst, but then I understood it as an expression of bewilderment at life. Now, they simply tell me each time I am about to leave home that I should consider staying back just a few more days.

As you struggle between your two homes and roles as mother/ father, wife/ husband & daughter/son, you comprehend the inevitable isolation, the physical debilities, the mental struggles & helplessness that old age brings in its fold. It is said life is short and one should make the most of it. One of the most satisfying ways to do this is by sharing responsibilities with siblings and working out ways you can provide love & care for your parents in the sunset of their lives. To ensure the best possible help you can provide, you also need to ensure that you take good care of yourself in the process.

AGEING PARENTS TEACH US THE DEEPEST MEANING OF ROLE REVERSAL

Naming What We Feel

Between depression and flourishing lies a complex emotional landscape that better vocabulary can help us understand

AUTHOR



ERA DUTTA

A patient told me recently: “Doctor, I am not depressed. I am not anxious either. I just feel stuck.” Another said: “Life is difficult right now, but somehow I still believe I will be okay.” Neither struggled to describe how they felt. They struggled to name it. For decades, our emotional vocabulary revolved around a handful of familiar words. Happy. Sad. Stressed. Anxious. Depressed. But human emotional experience has always been far more nuanced than that. And sometimes, simply discovering that a feeling has a name is surprisingly validating. Two such terms have quietly entered the mental health conversation: languishing and tragic optimism. **When you are not unhappy but not really living either** Imagine waking up every day, going to work, replying to emails, attending family dinners, and getting

through your responsibilities. On paper, everything looks fine. Yet nothing feels particularly exciting. You are not deeply sad, but you are not genuinely engaged either. Life feels flat. Psychologists call this languishing. It is not depression. People who are depressed often struggle with persistent sadness, hopelessness or loss of pleasure in things they once enjoyed. Someone who is languishing can still function well. The problem is that they are merely functioning. The pandemic introduced many people to this emotional state for the first time. Even after life returned to normal, countless people described feeling emotionally paused. Not falling apart, but simply not flourishing. Languishing creeps in quietly. You stop looking forward to weekends; your hobbies disappear. Days begin to blur together; you feel more disconnected than distressed. You are present, but not quite there. The solution is rarely dramatic. Sometimes, it is surprisingly ordinary: reconnecting with a friend, learning something new, spending time outdoors, or simply doing something that creates a small but genuine sense of purpose again. Flourishing rarely returns overnight. It returns through consistent, small actions deliberately chosen.



Hope without pretending everything is okay

At the other end of the emotional spectrum lies tragic optimism. Most of us are familiar with toxic positivity, which is the pressure to smile through pain, to believe everything happens for a reason, and to reframe every difficulty as a hidden blessing. While usually well-intentioned, toxic positivity often leaves people feeling unseen. Grief, disappointment and uncertainty become emotions to be fixed rather than experiences to be lived. Tragic optimism offers a healthier alternative. Coined by psychiatrist and Holocaust survivor Viktor Frankl, the term describes the ability to

NAMING COMPLEX FEELINGS CAN BE THE BEGINNING OF UNDERSTANDING OURSELVES

acknowledge suffering while still choosing hope. Not hope that denies reality, but instead hope that refuses to be defeated by it. It does not say everything is fine. It says things are hard, and life can still hold meaning. Tragic optimism is the parent caring for a chronically ill child who still finds reasons to smile on a Tuesday. The cancer survivor already planning next year’s holiday. The student who fails an important exam and applies again. Hope, in this framing, is not denial but a form of quiet courage. **Why these words matter** Mental health is not only about diagnosing disorders. It is also about understanding the rich emotional landscape that exists

between illness and full well-being. When we lack the right words, we judge ourselves unfairly. We call ourselves lazy when we are actually languishing. We think we are being negative when we are simply acknowledging that life is genuinely hard right now. Naming an emotion does not solve it. But it often gives us permission to stop fighting ourselves and start understanding ourselves. That shift, from self-criticism to self-comprehension, is

frequently where recovery begins. Sometimes, we are neither broken nor thriving. Sometimes, we are simply languishing, waiting for something to reignite us. And sometimes, even in the darkest chapters, we find ourselves practising tragic optimism without even knowing it had a name: the quiet belief that although today is difficult, tomorrow is still worth showing up for. Which one resonates with you currently?





ALI FAZAL ON 'MIRZAPUR: THE MOVIE'

'It's a national-level experiment'

He still remembers how he felt scared to step into the world of 'Mirzapur', the hinterland crime drama series which became a cult of its own

BEDIKA
New Delhi

Ali Fazal still remembers how he felt scared to step into the world of 'Mirzapur', the hinterland crime drama series which became a cult of its own and is now all set to explode on the big screen in a movie version.

The actor, who reprises his role of Guddu Pandit, the bodybuilder-turned-gangster in 'Mirzapur: The Movie', is excited for the buzz surrounding the show's cinematic extension. The movie will explore an untold chapter from the first season and also bring back many key characters.

"It's the first time in India that a show is being transformed into a film. It's a national-level experiment that we are doing. The story and the characters are all good. We are excited to share every (promotional) asset," Ali told PTI in an interview.

Launched in 2018, 'Mirzapur' emerged as one of India's most popular streaming shows with its gritty portrayal of crime, politics and power struggles in Uttar Pradesh. It was followed by two more seasons, which were equally praised by the critics and fans. Fazal starred alongside an ensemble cast of Pankaj Tripathi, Divyenndu, Shweta Tripathi, Rasika Dugal, Vijay Varma, Isha Talwar, Harshita Gaur and Shriya Pilgaonkar in the series, created by Puneet Krishna and Karan Anshuman.

The 39-year-old actor said he had earlier got to know that his 'Fukrey' director Mrighdeep Singh Lamba recommended his name to the makers of 'Mirzapur', which is produced by 'Excel Entertainment'.

Fazal, who was establishing himself in Hindi cinema and had also appeared in a couple of Hollywood films, said he was advised by many to stay away from the project. "I was scared at that time. I didn't know what the format would be. It was the first time that the first few shows were being made in India. The film-makers were telling me, 'What was I doing by saying yes?' They said, 'Do films'," he said.

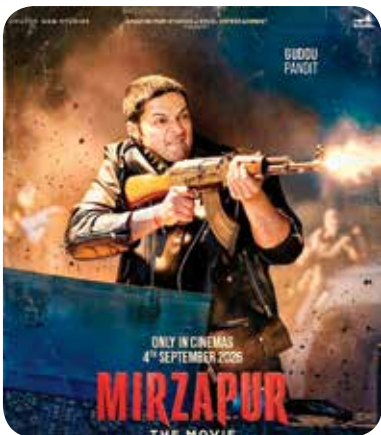
Having worked in the West, Fazal said he could see the industry was evolving and that helped him in saying yes. "I saw this changing era of OTT and shows. I felt a revolution was about to come. The way the script was written by Puneet Krishna, the world he has made of 'Mirzapur', it was really commendable. We had an idea about the hinterland and we would listen to stories, but I had never seen that place this way."

Looking back, Fazal believes the show gave him the space to play on his strengths. "Nobody could picture me as that character. It has been quite the journey," he added.

The official teaser of 'Mirzapur: The Movie', unveiled last month, promises to continue the saga on a larger cinematic scale. Besides Fazal, actors Divyenndu and Pankaj Tripathi are returning in their fan-favourite avatars of Munna Tripathi and Kaleen Bhaiya. They are joined by Jitendra Kumar, who takes over the role of Bablu Pandit, who was played by Vikrant Massey in the first season, while Ravi Kishan has been introduced as another important variable in the story.

Asked whether 'Mirzapur' has spoiled hinterland dramas for others with its sweeping popularity, Fazal said that's always the case with something that clicks. He gave the example of filmmaker Anurag Kashyap's two-part crime epic 'Gangs of Wasseypur'.

"Gangs of Wasseypur" was cult cinema. Many people took it from there. They made great characters. I met my wife (Richa Chadha), but



LAUNCHED IN 2018, 'MIRZAPUR' EMERGED AS ONE OF INDIA'S MOST POPULAR STREAMING SHOWS WITH ITS GRITTY PORTRAYAL OF CRIME, POLITICS AND POWER STRUGGLES IN UTTAR PRADESH

that's a different story. That's what happened in 'Mirzapur'. The canvas was like that. People got attached to the characters."

While he awaits the release of 'Mirzapur: The Movie' on September 4, Fazal was last seen in the 'Prime video' series "Raakh", directed by Prosit Roy. The eight-episode crime drama, a 1970s-set story inspired by the real-life case of murderers Ranga-Billa, features the actor as a conscientious police sub-inspector Jayprakash Jatav, who is bogged down by the system in his quest to find the killers of two innocent teens.

said it was a challenging series to do as one can never imagine the pain that a family goes through when a crime like this takes place. He wanted to play the character of a cop as someone who almost feels diminished. "There can be 10 other ways to play this character. I really wanted to understand the human condition behind this uniform. How, despite having so much power in that little frame, does society shape you? Even structurally in the show, I am large. But he is almost shy of his presence in society."

The show is set in Delhi during the post-Emergency period and Ali said they wanted to stay true to the era of a politically sensitive time. "This is a study of that time. All the paperwork was done in a way that was later changed. Everyone's language was very strong. Everyone spoke in Hindustani. No matter where you are from, your language is very correct. These were the small points that I found very interesting because at that time, there was no technology and no shortcuts," he said.

deep Yadav and Akash Ahuja's performance as the two murderers in the show that also features Aamir Bashir and Sonali Bendre. "The way they have played the roles of these two criminals is mind-blowing. It is also a study in the choices an actor makes. I am sure if some actors are watching this, they should really study. I really enjoyed watching their performances," he said.

"Raakh" could easily have been the story of his character, Jayprakash. But the makers ensured that the focus stayed on the victims and their family, Ali said. "The makers have given a tribute to the victims. A 'what if' scenario. It really breaks you," he said.

Ali has a special appearance in 'Batwara 1947', which features Sunny Deol, Shabana Azmi and Preity Zinta. The movie is directed by Rajkumar Santoshi. "It's an important film. I'm a small part of it. The main characters are Sunny Paji, Preity Zinta and Shabana ma'am. They are great actors. It was wonderful to work with Santoshi. Aamir Khan has produced it. I was glad to share notes with such wonderful people. It was sweet."

The actor is also part of Netflix's anthology series 'Lust Stories' in a segment directed by Shakun Batra. AGENCIES



The watchlist just got bigger!

Here are five returning series worth making room on the watchlist

OUR CORRESPONDENT

There is something particularly satisfying about returning to a show you already love. You know the characters; you are already invested in their lives and there is no need to spend three episodes figuring out whether you care. This month, some of television's biggest favourites return, with familiar faces stepping back into worlds we know, only to find new stories, bigger stakes and unfinished business waiting for them.

From Jack Reacher finding himself in the middle of another conspiracy to the tangled relationships of Silver Falls, the battle for Westeros, a new chapter at Richmond and another trip through Gotham, here are five returning series worth making room for on your watchlist:

Reacher S4 (Prime Video)

Jack Reacher has never been particularly good at minding his own business, which, fortunately, continues to work very well for Reacher. Alan Ritchson returns as



the former military investigator in a fourth season that once again drops him into trouble he never went looking for. Based on 'Gone Tomorrow', the 13th novel in Lee Child's bestselling series, the new season begins with a chance encounter with a distraught stranger on a New York subway. When the situation takes a dangerous turn, Reacher finds himself pulled into a conspiracy involving powerful people, hidden motives and enemies operating at the highest levels of capacity.

My Life With the Walter Boys S3 (Netflix)



Things were already complicated in Silver Falls before Jackie and Cole finally admitted their feelings, with Alex overhearing their confession only making things messier. Season 3 picks up in the aftermath, as the three are forced to confront everything left unsaid. The arrival of someone from Jackie's past in New York adds another layer, bringing her old life face to face with the one she has built in Silver Falls. Beyond the love triangle, the season explores Jackie's struggle between two versions of home and herself.

Ted Lasso S4 (Apple TV)

Just when it seemed like Richmond had said goodbye to Ted Lasso, the doors opened again. Jason Sudeikis returns as Ted, but season 4 is not simply trying to repeat the story that came before it. Instead, the series turns its attention to AFC Richmond's women's team, giving Ted a completely new challenge while bringing Rebecca, Keeley, Higgins and Coach Beard back into the picture. A new team brings a fresh set of personalities, ambitions and relationships to Richmond, while the characters audiences already love move into different phases of their lives.



House of the Dragon S3 (JioHotstar)



The Targaryens have spent two seasons moving towards war and season 3 finally takes House of the Dragon deeper into the Dance of the Dragons. As the fight for the Iron Throne grows bloodier, the conflict stretches far beyond Rhaenyra and Alicent's fractured relationship. With Emma D'Arcy, Matt Smith, Olivia Cooke and the ensemble returning, the Targaryen saga enters a more dangerous chapter where every victory comes at a cost.

Batman Caped Crusader S2 (Prime Video)

Gotham was never going to stay quiet for long. Batman Caped Crusader returns to the dark, noir-inspired Gotham that helped its first season feel distinct from the many Batman stories that have come before it. Rather than building its Bruce Wayne around elaborate gadgets and enormous action sequences, the series leans into Batman as a detective operating in a city where corruption, organised crime and increasingly strange villains are beginning to take hold. Season 2 continues that journey as Bruce's crusade becomes harder to separate from the city he is trying to save.

